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'NEVER FELT THAT I WASN'T A PART OF THIS WORLD' **P12**

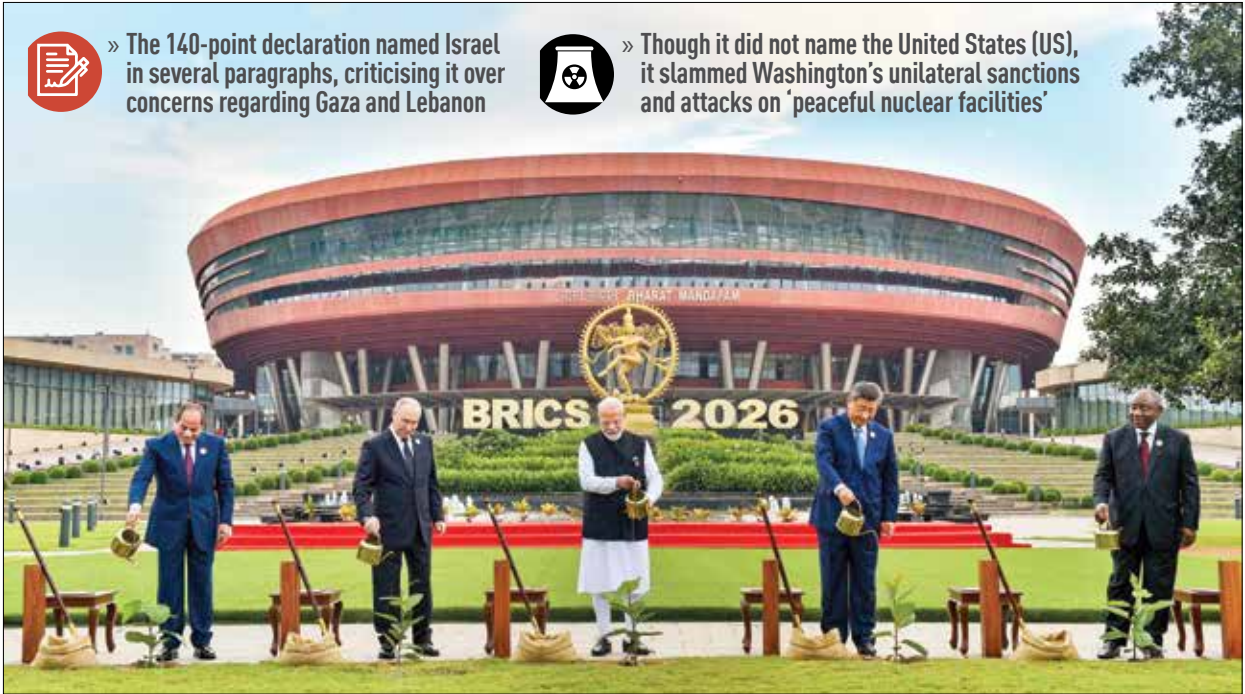
NEW DELHI DECLARATION ADOPTED | SANCTIONS SLAMMED, IRAN ECHOED | ISRAEL CALLED OUT | UNITY ON DISPLAY

## BRICS declaration slams US without naming it

VINAY KUMAR  
New Delhi, September 12

India pulled off a major diplomatic victory at the 18th BRICS Summit on Saturday with the adoption of a consensus joint declaration despite differences between Iran and the United Arab Emirates (UAE) over the West Asia crisis. The joint declaration did not make any direct references to the war and only emphasised upon dialogue and diplomacy to resolve conflicts.

Members of the BRICS grouping agreed to the comprehensive New Delhi Declaration in the evening. Prime Minister Narendra Modi announced the adoption of the declaration at the end of the opening day's deliberations in the presence of Chinese President Xi Jinping, Russian President Vladimir Putin and Iranian President Masoud Pezeshkian, Abu Dhabi Crown Prince Mohamed bin Zayed Al Nahyan and other top leaders of the bloc.



From left, Egyptian President Abdel Fattah el-Sisi, Russian President Vladimir Putin, Prime Minister Narendra Modi, Chinese President Xi Jinping and South African President Cyril Ramaphosa during a joint tree plantation initiative amid the ongoing 18th BRICS Summit, at the Bharat Mandapam

ers of the bloc. "We express deep concern over the continued escalation of tensions in West Asia and, recalling

our respective national positions, call for exercising maximum restraint, as well as avoiding actions that could further aggravate the

situation," the New Delhi Declaration said. The US was present in the joint declaration but without being named or

making any direct mention of the US strikes on Iran or the Iranian military's attacks on several Gulf Arab nations.

### DIPLOMATIC WIN

- » BRICS leaders plant great banyan tree saplings on day 1 of Summit
- » BRICS condemns Pahalgam terror attack, calls for zero tolerance on cross-border terrorism
- » Declaration vows cooperation to dismantle cross-border scam networks
- » Leaders call for stronger cooperation in disease surveillance, medical product regulation
- » Leaders reaffirm commitment to implementing 2030 agenda for sustainable development
- » Chinese president calls on BRICS countries to play 'due role' in bringing peace in West Asia

## Modi-Xi: Reset ties & keep disputes at bay

SIMONTINI BHATTACHARJEE  
New Delhi, September 12

Prime Minister Narendra Modi held a bilateral meeting with Chinese President Xi Jinping on the sidelines of the BRICS Summit here on Saturday, as India and China seek to reset ties, reaffirming that "differences should not become disputes."

PM Modi emphasised that peace and tranquility in the border areas "remains an essential basis for the continued development of bilateral relations," the Ministry of External Affairs (MEA) said in a statement following the meeting.

Xi landed in Delhi on Saturday to participate in the India-hosted BRICS Summit - his first visit in seven years. India-China ties suffered major setback in the months after military clashes in Ladakh's Galwan Valley.

"The two leaders welcomed the steady progress in India-China bilateral relations since their last meeting in Tianjin in August 2025. They reaffirmed that both countries should take a strategic and long term perspective of their ties. Differences should not become disputes. The Prime Minister highlighted that both sides must be guided by three mutuals - "mutual respect, mutual sensitivity and mutual interest," the MEA statement said.

PM Modi underlined the need for both sides to observe existing agreements and understandings on border related issues.



Prime Minister Narendra Modi during a bilateral meeting with Chinese President Xi Jinping

The two leaders expressed commitment to a fair, reasonable, and mutually acceptable resolution of the boundary question proceeding from the political perspective of their overall bilateral relations and the long-term interests of the two peoples.

The two leaders took note of the progress in people-to-people ties and underscored the need to further promote cultural exchanges, business linkages and greater mobility between the two countries. On economic and trade relations, they underlined the need to address each other's concerns, including structural trade imbalance and supply chain issues, and facilitation of meaningful and predictable market access.

They agreed that both sides must continue to expand common ground on regional and global issues, and in addressing challenges.

## Briefs

### Rawat quits posts after ED action

**DEHRADUN/NEW DELHI:** Senior Congress leader Harish Rawat on Saturday said he has decided to resign from all party posts after the ED seized cash and jewellery from his personal assistant's house, asserting that he is ready to go to jail if he is found involved in any wrongdoing.

Speaking to reporters in Delhi, the former Uttarakhand chief minister said he is resigning from the Pradesh Congress Committee executive and as a permanent invitee to the Congress Working Committee to ensure that the narrative regarding student-related

CONTINUED ON P4

### Bihar floods worsen, 48 lakh affected

**PATNA:** The flood situation in Bihar deteriorated on Saturday, with the number of affected people increasing to nearly 48 lakh across 15 districts, while several rivers, including the Ganga, were flowing above the danger levels.

The Water Resources Department (WRD) cautioned against sudden and rapid riverbank erosion, and directed its officials to maintain close vigil at vulnerable locations. "Due to the rise in water levels of several rivers, approximately 47.92 lakh people in 575 gram panchayats across 87 blocks in 15 districts have been affected by the floods," the Disaster Management Department said in a statement issued on Saturday.

SEE P4

## Four meets, one message: Secure the supply lines...

PM Modi holds bilateral talks with leaders

MPOST BUREAU  
New Delhi, September 12

Prime Minister Narendra Modi on Saturday held separate bilateral meetings with leaders from Malaysia, Vietnam, the United Arab Emirates, and Ethiopia, focusing on critical minerals, energy, and food security to shield trade and supply chains from rising global tensions.

The meetings took place on the sidelines of the BRICS Summit. In talks with Abu Dhabi Crown Prince Mohamed bin Zayed Al Nahyan, Modi discussed with him the overall situation in West Asia and ways to take forward the India-UAE strategic partnership.

"Discussed taking our strategic partnership forward across defence, AI, space, critical minerals, energy, food security and connectivity," Modi said in a social media post.

"At a time of uncertainty in West Asia, a strong India-UAE is a symbol of stability, prosperity and peace"



### OUTREACH

- » The meetings took place on the sidelines of the BRICS Summit
- » At a time of uncertainty in West Asia, a strong India-UAE is a symbol of stability, prosperity and peace
- » PM Modi appreciated Malaysia's continued support in strengthening ASEAN-India relations

bol of stability, prosperity and peace," he added.

In their meeting, Modi and Malaysian Prime Minister Anwar bin Ibrahim reviewed the progress in bilateral cooperation

across a range of areas, including trade and investment, defence and security, semiconductors, infrastructure, digital economy, energy and fintech.

Ibrahim conveyed to Modi Malaysia's concurrence to the establishment of an Indian consulate general's office in Kota Kinabalu, Sabah.

"Prime Minister Modi appreciated Malaysia's continued support in strengthening ASEAN-India relations. The leaders exchanged views on key regional and global issues of mutual interest," the Ministry of External Affairs (MEA) said.

The two leaders expressed their continued commitment to advancing the India-Malaysia Comprehensive Strategic Partnership, it said.

The meeting between Modi and Vietnamese Prime Minister Le Minh Hung largely focused on bilateral trade and investment ties.

CONTINUED ON P4

## Xi's No. 2 joins visit

MPOST BUREAU  
New Delhi, September 12

As Chinese President Xi Jinping arrived in India for the BRICS Summit, he was accompanied by a tall, silver-haired official - Cai Qi, widely regarded as China's second-most powerful leader and Xi's right-hand man.

Known for his unusually rapid rise through the Communist Party ranks, Cai's presence alongside Xi underscored the importance Beijing attaches to the visit as it seeks to reset ties with India following deadly border clashes.

In a statement on Saturday, China said Xi's entourage includes Cai Qi, a member of the standing committee of the political bureau of the Communist Party, and Foreign Minister Wang Yi. This will be Xi's first visit to India in nearly seven years. However, the presence of Cai Qi, a secretive figure known to work in the shadows, has generated considerable interest.

Off late, Cai Qi has been more visible. He held a meeting with Prime Minister Narendra Modi during his visit to Tianjin last year



PM Narendra Modi with Cai Qi during last year's Shanghai Cooperation Organisation summit in Tianjin

### HIGHLIGHTS

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- » This will be Xi's first visit to India in nearly seven years. However, the presence of Cai Qi, a secretive figure known to work in the shadows, has generated considerable interest

for the Shanghai Cooperation Organisation summit, and was spotted at the Xi-Trump meeting in South Korea in 2025. When Trump visited China earlier this year, the first man to shake the US President's hand was Cai Qi.

CONTINUED ON P4

## Air India pilot found dead in Delhi hotel

Police rule out foul play

OUR CORRESPONDENT  
New Delhi, September 12

An Air India pilot, in the city for Boeing 787 conversion training, died after being found unconscious in his hotel room during a layover, with police ruling out any foul play.

The pilot had checked into a hotel in Vasant Kunj on September 10 and was found dead there the next evening, police said. The pilot, who had previously

worked with Air India Express, was undergoing conversion training to operate wide-body Boeing 787 aircraft, according to airline officials.

A PCR call regarding the ill health of the hotel guest was received at Vasant Kunj North police station on September 11, following which police personnel reached the hotel and found him unconscious and unresponsive.

SEE P3



PRESS TRUST OF INDIA  
Beijing, September 12

China Southern Airlines on Saturday announced that it will resume regular passenger services on the Guangzhou-New Delhi route from September 21, restarting the service after a six-year suspension.

With the resumption, the airline will operate more than 100 weekly flights across eight round-trip routes in South Asia, the carrier said.

China Southern Airlines, headquartered in Guangzhou in China's southern Guangdong province, is one of the country's major carriers.

## BACK AFTER 6 YEARS

# Guangzhou-New Delhi link takes wing



The carrier's announcement coincides with Chinese President Xi Jinping's visit to India on Saturday to attend the BRICS summit

and hold talks with Prime Minister Narendra Modi on further improving bilateral relations.

The flight services between

India and China were suspended following the COVID-19 pandemic in 2020 and were not restored amid the over

CONTINUED ON P4

### RESTART

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- » China Southern Airlines, headquartered in Guangzhou in China's southern Guangdong province, is one of the country's major carriers
- » The flight services between India and China were suspended following the COVID-19 pandemic in 2020 and were not restored amid the over four-year military standoff between the two countries in eastern Ladakh

THERE IS NO MENTION OF A COMMON BRICS CURRENCY

# BRICS takes cautious stand on dollar dominance, focuses on payments

OUR CORRESPONDENT  
New Delhi, September 12

For a bloc that has spent years fuelling speculation about challenging the dollar's dominance, the formal position enunciated in a joint statement after meeting of finance ministers and central bank governors of BRICS nations remains more cautious than the rhetoric of some of its members.

There is no mention of a common BRICS currency or a formal call for replacement of the US dollar. Instead, the document sticks to the more incremental, technocratic language the bloc has used since Rio & Kazan: interoperable payment systems, local-currency settlement & voluntary cooperation among members who "respect national priorities."

Acknowledge efforts of the BRICS Payment Task Force (BPTF) towards exploring "pragmatic solutions for efficient cross-border payment mechanisms," the bloc said,"We encourage



age the BPTF to continue discussions, building on the ongoing work, to facilitate practical solutions for cross-border payments among BRICS countries, which are fast, low-cost, more accessible, efficient, transparent, and safe."

But statements made by Iranian President Masoud Pezeshkian and Russian President Vladimir Putin on Friday at BRICS Business Forum in New Delhi show why the issue of de-dollarisation remains central to the BRICS debate.

Pezeshkian made the most direct case for moving

away from the dollar. Speaking at the Forum, the Iranian president said BRICS should develop a more resilient network of trade, investment and financing and expand the use of national currencies.

He argued that the international financial system's concentration around a limited number of currencies leaves economies vulnerable to political shocks.

"One of the most important steps is to expand the use of national currencies in trade among the members. This step must be accompanied by the establishment

KEY POINTS

» The joint statement document sticks to interoperable payment systems, local-currency settlement, and voluntary cooperation among members

» But statements made by Iranian President Masoud Pezeshkian and Russian President Vladimir Putin show why the issue of de-dollarisation remains central to the BRICS debate

of the necessary instruments for managing currency risks and reciprocal settlements since the current financial system is vulnerable to political shocks due to its concentration on a limited number of currencies," the Iranian President said.

Ahead of the summit, Pezeshkian also said BRICS' financial mechanisms could allow member countries to conduct economic interactions with less dependence on the dollar. He pointed specifically to the NDB and said its financial capacity should help facilitate trans-

actions among members without reliance on the US currency.

For Iran, the issue carries particular urgency. Tehran is under extensive US sanctions and sees greater use of national currencies, alternative payment mechanisms and BRICS institutions as a way of reducing exposure to financial restrictions imposed through the dollar-based system.

Putin's message at the same Forum was broader but pointed in the same direction. The Russian president said attempts were being made to restrict international trade through sanctions, secondary sanctions and other measures, & argued that BRICS should build what he described as a "new, sustainable platform for global growth."

Russia has a particularly strong incentive to develop financial channels outside Western systems after sanctions dramatically restricted its access to parts of the dollar- and euro-based financial architecture.

## BRICS backs diverse energy mix

*Fossil fuels will continue to play an important role for emerging & developing economies, the bloc said*

OUR CORRESPONDENT  
New Delhi, September 12

BRICS countries on Saturday called for stronger energy security through diversified supply sources, resilient infrastructure and stable energy markets, while acknowledging that fossil fuels will continue to play an important role in the global energy mix, particularly for emerging and developing economies.

"We acknowledge fossil fuels will still play an important role in the world's energy mix, particularly for emerging markets and developing economies (EMDEs)," the New Delhi Declaration said.

At the same time, BRICS called for "just, orderly, equitable and inclusive energy transitions" and lower greenhouse-gas emissions, while stressing technological neutrality and the principle of common but differentiated responsibilities.

The grouping said energy security required "energy market stability and maintaining uninterrupted flows of energy from diverse sources", as well as stronger value

chains and protection of critical energy infrastructure, including cross-border facilities.

BRICS also endorsed the growing use of digital technologies in energy systems, saying artificial intelligence and advanced data analytics could improve grid management, renewable-energy integration and operational efficiency. The bloc welcomed the BRICS Guiding Principles on Smart Grids and Energy Storage and an Indian chairship initiative to establish a BRICS Digital Centre of Excellence for Smart Grids and Energy Storage as a voluntary platform for cooperation.

### NUCLEAR, HYDROGEN & RENEWABLES

BRICS said countries should pursue "balanced and diversified energy mixes reflecting national circumstances", recognising a broad range of technologies.

"The widest variety of energy sources and technologies including but not limited to renewable energy, bioenergy, fossil fuels, nuclear energy, hydropower, hydrogen, low carbon technologies, energy storage technolo-

gies, which play an important role in achieving the SDGs and energy security," the declaration said.

The bloc also encouraged cooperation on interoperable standards and certification for zero- and low-emission hydrogen and noted ongoing work on a joint report on hydrogen value chains.

### CRITICAL MINERALS

BRICS also placed greater emphasis on securing supplies of critical minerals needed for the energy transition.

"We affirm the need to promote reliable, responsible, diversified, resilient, fair, sustainable, and just supply chains of critical minerals," the declaration said.

It called for supply chains that ensure "benefit sharing, value addition and economic diversification in resource-rich countries", while preserving countries' sovereign rights over their mineral resources.

The declaration recognised the "key role of critical minerals for the development of zero- and low-emission energy technologies, energy security, and resilience of energy supply chains."

## RBI rejects Tata Sons' bid to surrender NBFC licence: Sources

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA  
Mumbai, September 12

The Reserve Bank of India (RBI) has rejected Tata Sons' application to surrender its non-banking finance company (NBFC) licence, which will force a public markets listing of the holding company of the salt-to-software conglomerate Tata Group, sources said on Saturday.

In a letter received by the Company Secretary and Chief Financial Officer on Saturday, the RBI specified that the group does not meet the necessary criteria, leading it to reject the March 2024 application for deregistration.

This makes a public markets listing of Tata Sons imminent as it is now qualified as an upper-layer NBFC, which must mandatorily list its businesses.

A response was awaited from Reserve Bank, when reached out for a comment. There was no immediate response from Tata Sons as well on the development.

## Sebi suggests changes to expiry-day settlement price methodology

AGENCIES  
New Delhi, September 12

Markets regulator Sebi on Saturday proposed changes to the methodology for determining expiry-day settlement prices of index and single-stock derivatives after reviewing the newly introduced closing auction session (CAS).

In a consultation paper, Sebi proposed two options: a blended Volume Weighted Average Price (VWAP) based on trades during the last 30 minutes of the continuous trad-



ing session (CTS) and the 10-minute CAS, or continuation of the existing CTS VWAP methodology.

The regulator said "hyperactivity" in expiring index options and derivatives trading linked to the Indicative Equilibrium Price during CAS warranted a review.

Under the blended

VWAP option, each period would contribute based on actual traded value, without fixed weights. Sebi said CTS VWAP could alternatively continue as an interim measure, with a possible shift to blended VWAP after at least one year, subject to adequate CAS liquidity and participation.

Sebi also proposed discontinuing the Indicative Index Value (IIV) display while retaining the Indicative Equilibrium Price (IEP) for individual securities. It has invited stakeholder comments by October 3.

## IIFCL-TERI National Policy Dialogue explores unlocking nuclear power investment, financing

MPOST BUREAU  
Mumbai, September 10

India Infrastructure Finance Company Ltd (IIFCL), with The Energy and Resources Institute (TERI), convened a National Policy Dialogue in Mumbai on "Unlocking the Future of Nuclear Power: Enabling Investment, Financing and Bankability".

IIFCL Deputy Managing Director Palash Srivastava, in his welcome address, stressed the need for an enabling financing ecosystem for nuclear power.



Rohit Rishi, Managing Director, IIFCL

TERI Distinguished Fellow Emeritus K Ram-anathan highlighted nuclear power's strategic role in India's energy transition & the government's 100 GW nuclear capacity

target by 2047.

IIFCL Managing Director Rohit Rishi said India must "significantly scale up nuclear power", noting its share at around 3 per cent in India against nearly 60 per cent in France & around 18 per cent in Russia & the US. He called for greater private-sector participation and long-term capital.

Chief Guest S.A. Bhardwaj, former Interim CMD, NPCIL, and former Chairmen of the Nuclear Fuel Complex Board and AERB, advocated moving from FOAK to NOAK deployment, supported by risk- and profit-sharing. Manoj Muttathil Ayyappan, Joint Secretary, Department of Financial Services, called for an appropriate financial architecture for nuclear infrastructure.

Sessions moderated by TERI Senior Director A K Saxena, IIFCL Chief Credit Officer Raj Kumar Ralhan and Chief Strategy Officer Salil Garg examined investment, financing and bankability challenges. Prof. Ravi Madhavan of the University of Pittsburgh made a presentation.



AGENCIES  
New Delhi, September 12

BRICS leaders on Saturday called for the immediate restoration of a fully functioning, two-tier and binding World Trade Organisation (WTO) dispute settlement mechanism, seeking to strengthen the credibility of the multilateral trading system.

In the New Delhi Declaration, the leaders reaffirmed their commitment to WTO reform and negotiations within its framework, calling for an open,

transparent, fair, inclusive and rules-based global trading system.

"We strongly advocate for the immediate restoration of an accessible, effective, fully functioning, two-tier binding WTO dispute settlement mechanism as a foundation for

## THE APPELLATE BODY STOPPED FUNCTIONING IN DECEMBER 2019 AFTER US BLOCKED APPOINTMENTS

trust and predictability for all WTO members, and the appointment of new Appellate Body members without further delay," the declaration said.

The WTO's 166 members use its dispute settlement system to resolve trade disputes, through

consultations and, where necessary, adjudication by panels and the Appellate Body. India has been a WTO member since 1995.

The Appellate Body stopped functioning in December 2019 after the US blocked appointments of new members. While panels continue to operate, several appeals remain unresolved.

BRICS members said they would engage constructively in WTO reform to enhance its authority, effectiveness, inclusiveness and relevance.

## Jindal Steel sets Guinness World Record with longest steel slag road

MPOST BUREAU  
New Delhi, September 12

Jindal Steel Limited, in collaboration with CSIR-Central Road Research Institute (CSIR-CRRI), has secured a Guinness World Records title for constructing the world's longest road using processed steel slag aggregates in Raigarh, Chhattisgarh.

The 1.85-km, four-lane divided road, equivalent to 7.4 lane-km, uses around 200,000 tonnes of processed EAF steel slag and



is designed for heavy commercial traffic.

The project enables 100 per cent replacement of natural aggregates, saving around 200,000 tonnes of

virgin stone and reducing quarrying. The pavement is about 35 per cent thinner, with estimated construction cost savings of up to 40 per cent.

## BRICS leaders oppose 'punitive, discriminatory' carbon border taxes

AGENCIES  
New Delhi, September 12

BRICS leaders on Saturday opposed unilateral, punitive and discriminatory measures such as carbon border adjustment mechanisms (CBAMs), saying they could undermine developing countries' efforts to address climate change.

The New Delhi Declaration said such measures, including carbon taxes planned by the EU and UK, could affect exports of iron and steel, cement, fertilisers and aluminium.

On intellectual property rights, leaders agreed



to expand cooperation on IP awareness, capacity building, commercialisation, patent examination, traditional knowledge, geographical indications and artificial intelligence. They also stressed respect for IP rights in the digital environment, including AI training, while protect-

ing developing countries' priorities.

The leaders reiterated the need for resilient, efficient, transparent, secure and inclusive global value chains (GVCs), and backed the BRICS GVC Action Plan 2026-2030. They called for greater digitisation of trade documentation, technology access, connectivity and capacity building.

They also sought greater participation of developing countries in higher-value manufacturing and production through trade, investment, technology transfer and stronger productive capacities.

## India's ethanol supply hits 895 cr litres in August

### Grain-based feedstocks contributed nearly 70% of cumulative supplies

AGENCIES  
New Delhi, September 12

Grain-based feedstocks have emerged as the dominant source of India's ethanol supply, accounting for nearly 70 per cent of cumulative supplies under Ethanol Supply Year (ESY) 2025-26 as of August-end, according to data compiled by the All India Distillers' Association (AIDA).

India's overall ethanol supplies reached 895 crore litres by the end of August, around 85 per cent

CLOSER LOOK

» Of the cumulative supplies, 624 crore litres came from grain-based feedstocks, while sugar-based feedstocks contributed 271 crore litres

» Among grain-based feedstocks, maize was largest contributor at 345 crore litres, followed by surplus FCI rice at 214 crore litres

of the 1,048 crore litres contracted.

Of the cumulative supplies, 624 crore litres came from grain-based feedstocks, while sugar-based feedstocks contributed 271 crore litres.

Among grain-based feedstocks, maize was the largest contributor at 345 crore litres, followed by surplus Food Corporation of India (FCI) rice at 214 crore litres and damaged food grains at 64

crore litres.

Sugar-based feedstocks contributed 271 crore litres, including 149 crore litres from sugarcane juice, 107 crore litres from B Heavy Molasses and 15 crore litres from C Heavy Molasses.

AIDA said the expansion in domestic ethanol production would increasingly require adequate and predictable avenues for utilisation as India moves beyond the existing blending framework towards wider adop-

tion of Flex-Fuel Vehicles (FFVs), Compressed Biogas (CBG), Sustainable Aviation Fuel (SAF) and other applications.

Bharati Balaji, Deputy Director General, AIDA, said the August-end data showed the significant evolution of India's ethanol supply ecosystem. She said the diversity of feedstocks was a key strength, enabling the industry to use multiple domestic agricultural resources and reduce dependence on any single feedstock pathway.



| NEW DELHI   |             |
|-------------|-------------|
| Temp on     | Saturday    |
| MAX 36.4 °C | MIN 26.8 °C |

FORECAST

POLICE RULE OUT FOUL PLAY

# Air India pilot found dead in Delhi hotel

OUR CORRESPONDENT  
New Delhi, September 12

An Air India pilot, in the city for Boeing 787 conversion training, died after being found unconscious in his hotel room during a layover, with police ruling out any foul play.

The pilot had checked into a hotel in Vasant Kunj on September 10 and was found dead there the next evening, police said. The pilot, who had previously worked with Air India Express, was undergoing conversion training to operate wide-body Boeing 787 aircraft, according to airline officials.

A PCR call regarding the ill health of the hotel guest was received at Vasant Kunj North police station on September 11, following which police personnel reached the hotel and found him unconscious and unresponsive.

He was immediately taken to a hospital, where he was declared dead, the police said. Police then called a crime team to the scene.

According to police, the

KEY POINTS

- » According to police, the pilot’s brother contacted the hotel manager on the evening of September 11 and told him his brother was not responding to his calls
- » The hotel manager then went to the room, which was locked from inside. It was opened with the help of the hotel’s master key, following which the pilot was found lying unconscious and unresponsive
- » The final cause of death will be ascertained after receipt of the final medical opinion

pilot’s brother contacted the hotel manager on the evening of September 11 and told him his brother was not responding to his calls. The hotel manager then went to the room, which was locked from inside. It was opened with the help of the hotel’s master key, following which the pilot was found lying

unconscious and unresponsive, police said.

The post-mortem examination was conducted at Safdarjung Hospital on September 12. The final cause of death will be ascertained after receipt of the final medical opinion.

Police said they were not suspecting foul play and were conducting inquest proceedings under Section 194 of the Bharatiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita.

Earlier, officials had said the pilot died due to cardiac arrest. Air India, in a statement, had said it was deeply saddened by the passing of a cockpit crew member in Delhi.

“He was on a layover rest at a hotel in Delhi where he was found unconscious last evening. He was rushed to the hospital immediately, where he was declared dead,” the airline had said.

Air India said it was in close touch with the pilot’s family and was extending all support during this time of grief.

Further enquiry is in progress, police said.

## Ridge plantations to get regular checks

New Delhi, September 12

The Delhi Forest Department is planning repeated checks of plantations in the Central and Southern Ridge to ensure that plantation work is properly carried out and the saplings are being maintained as intended, an official said on Saturday.

The department has invited bids to engage execution partners for multiple rounds of monitoring of plantations in the Central Ridge under the West Forest Division and the Southern Ridge under the South Forest Division.

An official told PTI that the exercise is aimed at ensuring that plantation drives are carried out properly and that the prescribed plantation-related requirements are followed on the ground, including checks on how the saplings are planted and whether the work is being properly maintained. The Delhi government has been undertaking a mega plantation drive in the Capital, with a target of planting around 70 lakh trees in 2026-27. PTI

# JMI hostel protest: Claims and denial

OUR CORRESPONDENT  
New Delhi, September 12

Amid the ongoing protest by students of Jamia Millia Islamia’s Jammu and Kashmir Girls’ Hostel, the All India Students’ Association (AISA) on Saturday accused the assistant proctor of assaulting students, a charge denied by the university.

University officials claimed that some students broke two hostel gates and manhandled members of the proctorial team late Friday night.

The protest, which entered its third day on Saturday, began after some students complained about poor quality food being served in the mess. They alleged that insects and foreign objects had been found in the food.

The students are demanding cancellation of the contract of the existing hostel mess vendor, appointment of female staff in the mess, and action against hostel authorities.

They are also seeking an assurance that the protesting students would not face disciplinary action.

AISA alleged that the university has failed to implement assurances given to the students regarding their demands.

It also alleged that Assistant Proctor Maqsood Ahmad Malik manhandled and assaulted students near the Dean of Students’ Welfare office around 1 am on Friday after they resisted his attempts to intimidate them. The mobile phone of a student was snatched as she was recording the incident, the students’ body alleged.

According to AISA, electricity was switched off in the area near the Centenary Gate where the students were protesting and barricades were put up to isolate them. University officials, however, said most of the students’ demands were accepted on the first day of the protest and accused the protesters of escalating the situation.

# Husband, girlfriend arrested for murder

OUR CORRESPONDENT  
New Delhi, September 12

A 22-year-old man and his alleged girlfriend have been arrested in connection with the murder of his wife in Delhi’s Prahlapdur last month, with police saying their relationship emerging as the motive behind the killing.

The accused, identified as Md Lal Babu alias Zahid Ali and Rukhsar Khatoun, were arrested following an extensive investigation that involved scrutiny of more than 300 CCTV cameras across Delhi, Ghaziabad, Noida, Patna, Sitamarhi, Muzaffarpur and Mumbai, police said on Saturday.

According to police, Lal Babu allegedly conspired with Rukhsar and murdered his wife Sabilla Khatun inside the bathroom of a house in Prahlapdur.

A case under Section 103(I) (murder) of the BNS was registered at the Shahbad Dairy police station on August 29 following the

murder, they said.

Police said Lal Babu and Sabilla were married and residing in Prahlapdur, adding that the former was allegedly in a relationship with Rukhsar and wanted to marry her.

After the murder, Lal Babu allegedly fled Delhi with his minor son towards Noida, where he contacted his maternal cousin Md Osama, police said.

Osama allegedly provided shelter and assistance to Lal Babu and facilitated his movement towards Bihar to evade arrest. He was arrested earlier in the investigation and sent to judicial custody, police said.

Following the murder, police conducted searches at multiple locations and carried out technical analysis and field verification to track the accused.

Investigators traced the routes and locations allegedly used by Lal Babu after the crime and eventually located him and Rukhsar, police said.

SEALS FIVE PROPERTIES

# MCD carries out 33 demolition actions



OUR CORRESPONDENT  
New Delhi, September 12

The Municipal Corporation of Delhi (MCD) on Saturday carried out 33 demolition actions across all 12 zones of the city and sealed five properties as part of an intensified crackdown on dangerous buildings, unauthorised constructions and building norm violations, officials said.

The civic body also issued 29 show-cause notices during the day’s enforcement drive, taking the number of demolition actions carried out over the last two days to 58.

On Friday, the MCD had

Rain and cloudy skies greeted the national capital on Saturday, with several parts of the city receiving showers during the day.

Meteorologists predicted that rainfall is likely in the city till September 16 and said the ongoing spell could be one of the last major spells of rain in the national capital.

The southwest monsoon is expected to withdraw from Delhi after September 21, with its departure likely to be slightly delayed this year, they said.

According to the India Meteorological Department, Safdarjung recorded 3.4 mm of rainfall between 8.30 am and 5.30 pm, while Lodi Road and Ayanagar recorded 0.5 mm each. Palam received trace rain-

# L-G approves health scheme for registered construction workers

OUR CORRESPONDENT  
New Delhi, September 12

Delhi Lieutenant Governor Taranjit Singh Sandhu has approved the Delhi Building Workers Health Scheme for registered building and other construction workers and their eligible dependent family members, according to a statement issued on Saturday.

The scheme was earlier approved by Chief Minister Rekha Gupta and the Delhi Cabinet.

“Under the scheme, every registered construction worker and their eligible spouse will receive an annual health check-up, along with cashless outpatient consultation, diagnostics, medicines and inpatient treatment through a network of empanelled hospitals functioning at CGHS rates,” the statement said.

The scheme will cover emergency treatment, occupational diseases, chronic illnesses, specialised care, maternal healthcare and rehabilitation, with treatment available up to Rs 2 lakh per beneficiary annually, subject to an overall family limit of Rs 10 lakh a year, it said.

“In the event of a work-site accident or medical emergency, beneficiaries



fall during the period, while no rain was recorded at Ridge. The 24-hour cumulative rainfall till 8.30 am was 1.8 mm at Safdarjung, 4.7 mm at Palam, 2.4 mm at Lodi Road, 10.6 mm at Ridge and 10.3 mm at

Ayanagar. During the day, the maximum temperature remained above normal at most weather stations in the city. Safdarjung recorded a maximum temperature of 36.4 degrees Celsius, 2.9 degrees above normal,

while Palam recorded 33.8 degrees Celsius, 0.3 degrees above normal.

Lodi Road recorded 35 degrees Celsius, two degrees above normal; Ridge 33.6 degrees Celsius, normal for the season; and

Ayanagar 34 degrees Celsius, 0.4 degrees below normal.

The minimum temperature at Safdarjung was 26.8 degrees Celsius, 1.2 degrees above normal. Palam recorded 24.1 degrees Celsius, 1.1 degrees below normal; Lodi Road 26.2 degrees Celsius, 1.2 degrees above normal; Ridge 22.5 degrees Celsius, two degrees below normal; and Ayanagar 25.5 degrees Celsius, 0.8 degrees above normal.

Continuing its streak of satisfactory air quality days, Delhi recorded an Air Quality Index of 62 on Saturday, according to the Central Pollution Control Board. According to the CPCB, an AQI of 0-50 is considered good, 51-100 satisfactory, 101-200 moderate, 201-300 poor, 301-400 very poor and 401-500 severe.

# CM: New forensic science lab to be built at Sheikh Sarai in 2 yrs

OUR CORRESPONDENT  
New Delhi, September 12



In a move to strengthen criminal investigations, a state-of-the-art Regional Forensic Science Laboratory (RFSL) will come up at Sheikh Sarai in South Delhi in the next two years, Chief Minister Rekha Gupta said on Saturday.

The proposal to construct the facility at a cost of Rs 151.81 crore was approved by the Expendi-

ture Finance Committee recently. The chief minister said that forensic science is essential not only for scientific investigation in criminal cases but also for criminal trials and the process of delivering justice.

“The new RFSL will

be built on a plot measuring approximately 6,300 square metres, with a total built-up area of 18,300 square metres. The building, to be constructed by the PWD, will be developed as an integrated forensic facility, keeping in mind the specialised requirements of scientific investigations,” Gupta said. The chief minister has set a target for the Public Works Department (PWD) to complete the construction within two years.

## Dengue Prevention is Simple!

Alertness can save you & family from Dengue

Dengue mosquito breeds in clean stagnant water

Prevent Mosquito breeding

Don't allow water to stagnate inside your home, in flower vase and anywhere in the surroundings.

Empty the water cooler every week or put some oil / petrol in it.

Always cover the bucket, water tank, other utensils properly

Prevent Mosquito bites

Wear full sleeves and use mosquito repellants

Use mosquito net at home & hospitals regularly during fever

### Symptoms of Dengue

High Fever

Severe pain behind the eyes that increases with eye movements

Headache, muscle and joint pain

Stomachache

Nausea and vomiting

Rashes on body

For Any Queries, Please Contact : Name of DHOs with Contact Number & Zone (District)

|                                                          |                                                          |                                                         |
|----------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------|
| 1. Dr. Hemant Kumar City SP (Old Delhi) 9990978034       | 5. Dr. V.N. Bhagat KPZ (Central North) 9717750141        | 9. Dr. Ajay Handa Shahdra-s (East) 9811015714           |
| 2. Dr. Nageshwar Marandi Central (South East) 9958001160 | 6. Dr. Madhuri Panth Narela (Outer North) 9958648615     | 10. Dr. Santosh Tomar Shahdra-s (North East) 9818579090 |
| 3. Dr. Sandeep Salve Civil Line (North) 8600598179       | 7. Dr. Vishal C. Soyam Najafgarh (South West) 9560945471 | 11. Dr. Deepak Mittal South (South) 8130698279          |
| 4. Dr. Aniket Sirohi KBZ (Central) 7217785459            | 8. Dr. Kanika Singh Rohini (North West) 9319733556       | 12. Dr. Ajay Kumar West (West) 9871663908               |

Issued in Public Interest by: Public Health Department Municipal Corporation of Delhi

National Vector Borne Diseases Control Program Directorate General of Health Services, Delhi Government

NATIONAL HEALTH MISSION

RO No. 27/DP/MCD/2026-27

NO WOMAN SECRETARY GENERAL TILL NOW

# BRICS pitches for comprehensive reforms of UN & Security Council

OUR CORRESPONDENT  
New Delhi, September 12

The BRICS on Saturday appeared to root for a woman helming the post of UN Secretary-General, as it pitched for a “comprehensive reform” of the world body, including its Security Council.

‘The New Delhi Declaration’, adopted on the opening day of the two-day BRICS summit, also takes note that “no woman has ever been elected for the role of Secretary-General of the United Nations, and only one national from Latin America and the Caribbean, and two nationals from Africa and Asia each have ever occupied the position”.

Prime Minister Narendra Modi announced the adoption of the declaration at the end of the opening day’s deliberations in the presence of Chinese President Xi Jinping, Russian President Vladimir Putin, Iranian President Masoud Pezeshkian, Abu Dhabi Crown Prince Mohamed bin Zayed Al Nahyan and other top leaders of the bloc.

The New Delhi Declaration is being seen as a major triumph for



**‘THE NEW DELHI DECLARATION’, ADOPTED ON THE OPENING DAY OF THE TWO-DAY BRICS SUMMIT, ALSO TAKES NOTE THAT ONLY ONE NATIONAL FROM LATIN AMERICA AND THE CARIBBEAN, AND TWO NATIONALS FROM AFRICA AND ASIA EACH HAVE EVER OCCUPIED THE POSITION’**

Indian diplomacy.

Recognising the 2023 Johannesburg-II Leaders’ Declaration, the BRICS leaders said, “We reiterate our support for a comprehensive reform of the UN, including its Security Council, with a view to making it more democratic, representative, effective and efficient, and to increase the representation of developing countries in the council’s membership so that it can adequately respond to pre-

vailing global challenges.”

They also reiterated their commitment to the full implementation of United Nations Security Council Resolution 1325 adopted in 2000 and subsequent resolutions and to the advancement of the Women, Peace and Security agenda. “We further reiterate the importance of ensuring the full, equal, safe, and meaningful participation of women in decision-making at all levels of peace and security

KEY POINTS

» Prime Minister Narendra Modi announced the adoption of the declaration at the end of the opening day’s deliberations

» Recognising the 2023 Johannesburg-II Leaders’ Declaration, the BRICS leaders said, ‘We reiterate our support for a comprehensive reform of the UN, including its Security Council’

» They also reiterated their commitment to the full implementation of UN Security Council Resolution 1325 adopted in 2000 and subsequent resolutions and to advancement of Women, Peace and Security agenda

processes, including conflict prevention and resolution, humanitarian relief, mediation, peace operations, peacebuilding, and post-conflict reconstruction and development,” it reads.

On October 31, 2000, the United Nations Security Council (UNSC) unanimously adopted resolution 1325. After years of advocacy, this marked the launch of what’s known as the Women, Peace and Security agenda, according

to the UN Women website.

In simple terms, global leaders “committed to a new way of looking at conflict and peace”, beyond the warring parties and traditional powerbrokers - both dominated by men, even today, the website adds.

Resolution 1325 acknowledges that women and girls are harmed by conflict in ways that are distinct, horrific and must be stopped, and it establishes that women’s meaningful participation in peace processes is essential to preventing, ending and recovering from conflict. As the current chair of BRICS, India is hosting the two-day summit at the Bharat Mandapam in New Delhi.

The declaration further reads that in light of the ongoing selection process of the next Secretary-General of the UN and bearing in mind the relevant provisions of the UN Charter, “We note that no woman has ever been elected for the role of secretary-general, and only one national from Latin America and the Caribbean, and only two nationals from Africa and Asia each have ever occupied this position.”

## Bihar flood situation remains grim, over 48 lakh affected

OUR CORRESPONDENT  
Patna, September 12

The flood situation in Bihar deteriorated on Saturday, with the number of affected people increasing to nearly 48.22 lakh across 15 districts, while several rivers, including the Ganga, were flowing above the danger levels.

The Water Resources Department (WRD) cautioned against sudden and rapid riverbank erosion, and directed its officials to maintain close vigil at vulnerable locations.

Due to the rise in water levels of several rivers, approximately 48.22 lakh people in 574 gram panchayats across 87 blocks in 15 districts have been affected by the floods, the Disaster Management Department said in a statement issued on Saturday.

The flood-hit districts are Patna, Bhojpur, Saran, Vaishali, Bhagalpur, Begusarai, Buxar, Samastipur, Munger, Katihar, Lakhisarai, Khagaria, Purnia, Madhepura and Araria. The count of flood-affected people was 47.33 lakh on Friday evening.

The government also instructed officials to ensure prompt reporting of any erosion incident and

to keep adequate resources readily available at vulnerable locations.

Incessant rain in Bihar, coupled with downpours in catchment areas of Nepal, has caused several rivers and streams to swell, officials said.

The state has recorded 108.8 mm of rainfall in September so far, about 20 per cent above normal, they said.

The Disaster Management Department said the Ganga was flowing at 36.48 metres at Sultan-ganj in Bhagalpur at 6 am on Saturday, 1.98 metres above the danger level, though the water level was receding.

The water levels of the Gandak at Dumariaghat, the Kosi at Baltara and Kursela, the Burhi Gandak at Khagaria, the Ganga at Digha, Gandhi Ghat, Hathidah, Bhagalpur, Khatgaon and Munger, the Punpun at Sripalpur, the Bagmati at Benibad, and the Ghaghra at Darauli and Gangpur Siswan were flowing above the danger marks, the Water Resources Department said.

It stated that a sudden reduction in water levels could increase the risk of bank erosion, posing a threat to vulnerable stretches of riverbanks and embankments.

## Iranian Prez Pezeshkian meets Abu Dhabi Crown Prince in Delhi

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA  
Patna, September 12

Iranian President Masoud Pezeshkian held talks with Abu Dhabi Crown Prince Sheikh Khaled bin Mohamed bin Zayed Al Nahyan in New Delhi on the sidelines of the BRICS summit on Saturday.

The meeting assumed significance as relations between the two sides came under severe strain after Iran targeted many US bases in the UAE in the last few months as part of its retaliation to the US attacks on Iranian installations.

“Iranian President Masoud Pezeshkian met with UAE Crown Prince Khaled bin Mohamed bin Zayed Al Nahyan on the sidelines of the BRICS Summit,” the Iranian embassy said on social media.

The meeting came amid reports about Iran’s plans to meet members of the Gulf Cooperation Council (GCC) and Iraq in Oman on September 14 to discuss an agreement on transit through the Strait of Hormuz.

It will be the first such meeting since the start of the West Asia conflict.

From page 1

## BRICS declaration slams US without naming it

Lebanon. Though it did not name the United States (US), it slammed Washington’s unilateral sanctions and attacks on “peaceful nuclear facilities.”

The New Delhi Declaration also did not criticise Russia’s war on Ukraine but was severely critical of Israel for continuing violence in Gaza and called for fulfilling the aspirations of the Palestinian people.

BRICS, without naming the US, also voiced serious concerns over the proliferation of “trade-restrictive actions” such as “indiscriminate” tariffs and non-tariff measures as well as protectionism, saying they threatened to further reduce global trade, disrupt global supply chains, potentially exacerbating existing economic disparities.

“We condemn the imposition of unilateral coercive measures that are contrary to international law, and reiterate that such measures, inter alia in the form of unilateral economic sanctions and secondary sanctions, have far-reaching negative implications,” the declaration said, adding that such economic sanctions end up “disproportionately affecting the poor”.

The BRICS leaders seemed to agree with India’s position to end the West Asia conflict through “dialogue and diplomacy” and stressed the need to work together to maintain a smooth flow of global trade, supply chains and energy, in accordance with “applicable” international law.

On Israel, the declaration highlighted its legal obligation to allow humanitarian aid into Gaza and opposed forced Palestinian displacement. On Lebanon, it went further, asking Israel to “withdraw its occupying forces from all of the Lebanese territories” where they remain.

The negotiations on the text of the declaration went down to the wire as both Iran and the UAE had hardened their positions initially. BRICS is a consensus-based grouping, meaning any single member can block a final joint declaration.

“We reaffirm that a just and lasting solution to the Israeli-Palestinian conflict can only be achieved by peaceful means and depends on the fulfilment of the legitimate rights of the Palestinian people, including the rights to self-determination and return,” it said.

BRICS also fully backed India’s call for zero tolerance towards any form of terrorism and shunning double standards in countering the menace, as the top leaders of the influential grouping agreed to have a concerted approach in dealing with the challenge.

The grouping also condemned in the “strongest terms” the Pahalgam terror attack in Jammu and Kashmir last year that killed 26 people.

“We reaffirm our commitment to combatting terrorism in all its forms and manifestations, including the cross-border movement of terrorists, terrorism financing and safe havens,” it said.

“We reiterate that terrorism should not be associated with any religion, nationality, civilization or ethnic group and that all those involved in terrorist activities and their support must be held accountable and brought to justice in accordance with relevant national and international law,” it said.

“We urge to ensure zero tolerance for terrorism and reject double standards in countering terrorism,” it added.

BRICS emphasised that it is the primary responsibility of states in combating terrorism and that global efforts to prevent and counter terrorist threats must fully comply with their obligations under international law, including the Charter of the UN.

BRICS also pressed for reform of the United Nations and even favoured having a woman as the UN Secretary General.

“In light of the ongoing selection process of the next Secretary-General of the UN and bearing in mind the relevant provisions of the UN Charter, we note that no woman has ever been elected for the role of Secretary General, and only one national from Latin America and the Caribbean, and only two nationals from Africa and Asia each have ever occupied this position,” it said.

BRICS also noted with concern the polarisation and distrust in the geopolitical landscape and called on the international community to respond to various security threats through politico-diplomatic measures.

“We underscore that security among all countries is indivisible and reiterate our commitment to the peaceful resolution of international disputes through dialogue, consultation and diplomacy.”

“We encourage the active role of regional organisations in conflict prevention and resolution and support all efforts conducive to the peaceful settlement of crises,” BRICS said in the declaration adopted during its 18th summit.

## Modi-Xi: Reset ties & keep disputes at bay

PM Modi appreciated China’s support for India’s BRICS chairship and its contributions toward the success of the 18th BRICS Summit-2026.

In talks with Modi, Xi described India and China as “important members” of the Global South and said the two nations “shoulder significant responsibilities”.

“In the face of a complex international landscape marked by intertwined changes and challenges, China and India, as the world’s two most populous countries and important members of the Global South, shoulder significant responsibilities. Both sides should keep the future of humanity in mind and the well-being of their peoples at heart, and work together to advance high-quality cooperation within the greater BRICS framework. We should advocate an equal and orderly multipolar world and an inclusive, mutually beneficial form of economic globalisation, injecting more positive energy into the promotion of world peace, stability, development and prosperity,” Xi said.

Addressing the BRICS Summit, Xi Jinping said that China would work with other mem-

bers of the BRICS bloc towards that goal, as the conflict in the Middle East “does not serve the common interests of the international community”, reports quoting state-run CCTV.

The Chinese President urged the BRICS bloc to be a peacemaker in the Middle East conflict. “China will work with other BRICS members in that role, as the war does not serve the common interests of the international community”, CCTV quoted Xi as saying.

Speaking on cooperation within the BRICS context, Xi stressed that the two nations must always think about “the future of humanity” and the welfare of their people.

The Modi-Xi talks hold a lot of significance considering that New Delhi and Beijing are trying to overcome the mistrust created due to the 2020 clash along the LAC.

There have been improvements, nonetheless, in the past few years, with diplomatic and military interactions smoothing out tensions on the border. Political interactions have also come amidst broader geopolitical changes such as the increased volatility in India and China’s relationships with the United States.

## Xi’s No. 2 joins visit

These may be small gestures, but the optics reveal Cai’s standing in Xi’s eyes.

It is no secret that China offers little insight into how its powerful government works. The sudden spotlight on Cai Qi offers a window into China’s power players and how Beijing plans to chart its future course.

With agency inputs

## Four meets, one message: Secure the supply lines

“The meeting provided an opportunity for both leaders to review the progress made in bilateral ties, which were elevated to an Enhanced Comprehensive Strategic Partnership,” the MEA said.

It said both leaders also exchanged views on various regional and global issues of mutual importance, and reaffirmed the commitment to further strengthening their partnership.

“India and Vietnam share a time-tested friendship rooted in shared civilisational heritage, mutual trust and understanding. Vietnam is a key pillar of India’s Act East Policy and an important partner in India’s broader engagement with Southeast Asia,” the MEA said.

Modi’s talks with his Ethiopian counterpart Abiy Ahmed Ali too centred around ways to further expand two-way relations in areas of defence and trade.

“The two leaders held discussions aimed at further strengthening the bilateral strategic partnership. They reviewed progress across key sectors, including economic cooperation, defence and security partnership, and capacity building,” the MEA said.

The meeting built on Modi’s visit to Addis Ababa in December last year.

“The two leaders also exchanged per-

spectives on regional and international developments of mutual interest. They reaffirmed their commitment to close cooperation in multilateral fora,” the MEA noted.

## Guangzhou-New Delhi link takes wing

four-year military standoff between the two countries in eastern Ladakh, which ended in October last year.

The resumption of flights is part of the gradual normalisation of India-China relations following two meetings between Modi and Xi in 2024 and 2025.

Modi and Xi met on the sidelines of the BRICS summit in Kazan, Russia, in October 2024, followed by another meeting during the Shanghai Cooperation Organisation summit in Tianjin in 2025.

Following the improvement in ties, several Chinese and Indian airlines resumed flight services between cities in the two countries, including the Beijing-New Delhi route.

In March this year, IndiGo launched a daily flight between Shanghai and Kolkata, further improving air connectivity between India and China.

## Rawat quits posts after ED action

issues raised by Rahul Gandhi and the party’s campaign ahead of the upcoming assembly elections are not weakened.

Sources close to Rawat said that he would soon meet Congress president Mallikarjun Kharge to submit his resignation from both posts.

The former CM remarked that a lot is at stake in the Uttarakhand assembly elections due early next year and claimed that the ED action was an attempt to create a specific narrative.

Rawat also said he is resigning from the two organisational posts, not from the Congress party. There is a “big difference” between resigning from an organisational post and resigning from the party, he said.

The development comes after a dozen luxury wristwatches and Rs 32 lakh in cash were seized from the premises of Chandan Singh Jeena during the Enforcement Directorate raids undertaken on Thursday. Jeena is currently Rawat’s personal assistant and had earlier served as an officer on special duty during the Congress leader’s tenure as chief minister during 2014-17.

The ED said that the raids were conducted as part of a money laundering investigation linked to alleged irregularities in a 2016 exam conducted by the state service selection commission.

Defending his personal assistant, Rawat said that Jeena could not possibly have a role in the matter.

According to Rawat, Jeena has been handling responsibilities with him for a long time and is an “extremely decent, humble, and hardworking person”.

He stated that if there is any evidence of tampering with OMR sheets during the recruitment process, he would be ashamed of such an act, but for now, he does not

believe these allegations.

Rawat said that the Congress and its workers are fighting against corruption, and Rahul Gandhi is raising his voice against corruption in the education system at the national level through the ‘Chhatron Ki Goonj’ campaign.

Referring to the recruitment process during his tenure as CM, Rawat said the Subordinate Services Selection Commission was constituted with the future of the state’s youth in mind.

According to Rawat, over 42,000 government posts were filled during his tenure of approximately three years.

He noted that his government had established various recruitment boards—including those for medical and education recruitment— and had compelled the Public Service Commission to conduct examinations on time.

## ‘Millet pulao’ and ‘paneer lababdar’ on BRICS dinner menu

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA  
New Delhi, September 12

‘Paneer lababdar’, ‘gucchi marmik’, ‘millet pulao’, and ‘shahtoot phirni’ for desserts were among the Indian delicacies served to the leaders and delegates of the BRICS Summit at a gala dinner hosted by Prime Minister Narendra Modi at the Bharat Mandapam on Saturday.

The state-of-the-art complex was decked up for the occasion.

India is hosting the BRICS Summit at the sprawling venue in central Delhi on September 12-13.

The first day saw the presence of Chinese President Xi Jinping, Russian President Vladimir Putin and several other heads of state, among other top dignitaries.

The menu included ‘khandvi mille’ and ‘khumb galouti’ as starters, people familiar with the matter said.

‘Khandvi mille’ is a feuille steamed gram-flour roll, tempered with mustard, coconut and curry leaves. It is served with kesar mango, micro-greens and yoghurt dressing.

‘Khumb galouti’ is tender pan-grilled mushroom kebabs with mint pearls, served on a bed of sheermal bread, they said.

The main course offered ‘paneer lababdar’ -- soft cottage cheese cubes simmered in a rich gravy of shallots and tomato; ‘gucchi marmik’ -- Himalayan morel mushrooms and tender asparagus, gently simmered with saffron, raisins, and mamra almonds; and ‘carrot bean poriyal’ -- blend of carrots and green beans toasted in aromatic South Indian spices in hand-pressed virgin coconut oil and finished with freshly grated coconut.

# कार्यालय नगर पालिका परिषद, डबर, जिला-ग्यालियार (म.प्र.)

क्रमांक / 3347 / लो.नि.शा. / ई-टेंडर / 2026

डबर, दिनांक 10.09.2026

## // द्वितीय निविदा आमंत्रण सूचना //

एतद द्वारा केन्द्रीयकृत प्रणाली के अन्तर्गत लोक निर्माण विभाग में पंजीकृत ठेकेदारो से ऑनलाईन निविदायें मध्यप्रदेश नगरीय प्रशासन एवं विकास विभाग का आई.एस.एस.आर. प्रभावशील दिनांक 02 अगस्त 2021 से आज दिनांक तक संशोधित सहित अपेन्डिक्स 2.10 प्रपत्र-ए पर प्रतिष्ठित दलों के आधार पर ई-टेंडरिंग वेबसाईट <https://www.mptender.gov.in/> पर नीचे दक्षित तालिका अनुसार निम्न कार्य आनलाईन निविदा दिनांक 24.09.2026 समय 5:30 तक आमंत्रित की जाती है।

| क्र. | सिस्टम<br>(ऑनलाईन) टेंडर<br>नम्बर | प्रकरण<br>क्रमांक                    | कार्य का नाम                                                                                  | प्राक्कलन<br>राशि | अमानत राशि | निविदा<br>प्रपत्र राशि | कार्य<br>की<br>अवधि |
|------|-----------------------------------|--------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------|------------|------------------------|---------------------|
| 1    |                                   | 2                                    | 3                                                                                             | 4                 | 5          | 6                      | 7                   |
| 1    | 2026<br>UAD_535695_1              | 6/2025 / 13 / 1<br>7 / 2025 / 13 / 1 | स्वच्छ भारत मिशन<br>(लाहरी) 2.0 MRF /<br>Composting Plant<br>का निर्माण / सुदृढीकरण<br>कार्य। | 1,73,48,000 / -   | 86,740 / - | 12,500 / -             | 06 माह              |

नोट :- नियम शर्त कार्यालय के लोक निर्माण शाखा एवं ऑनलाईन रूप से देखी जा सकती हैं। निविदा में किया गया कोई भी संशोधन उक्त वेबसाईट पर किया जावेगा पृथक से कोई भी प्रकाशन नहीं किया जावेगा।

(श्रीमति लक्ष्मी देवी पूरन सिंह राजा)

(सुश्री साक्षी बाजपेयी)

मुख्य नगरपालिका अधिकारी  
नगर पालिका परिषद, डबर

अध्यक्ष

नगर पालिका परिषद, डबर

News at a glance

Lebanese army detains Bashar Assad’s relative

**BEIRUT:** Lebanese authorities have detained a relative of ousted Syrian President Bashar Assad along with the son of a notorious drug dealer in northeast Lebanon on charges of carrying weapons and drugs, officials and the Lebanese army said Saturday.

Suleiman Assad and Ali Zeiter, son of Noah Zeiter, the suspected drug trafficker arrested last year, were detained Friday near the northeastern city of Baalbek, said the two judicial officials, who spoke on condition of anonymity.

Lebanon’s president makes a rare visit to southern city

**BEIRUT:** A Lebanon’s president made a rare visit to a southern city Saturday, close to where Israel captured a strategic hill, amid fears of more Israeli attacks.

President Joseph Aoun’s visit to Nabatiyeh came after Israel seized parts of Ali Taher ridge earlier this month, where Israeli officials said they had blown up Hezbollah tunnel networks, despite a June 20, US-brokered ceasefire between Israel and the Lebanese militant group. Aoun said the state will follow up on the needs of the residents “so that you stay here.”

French military jets launch 40-day global flight

**EIELSON AIR FORCE BASE:** Four fighter jets rose into the air over a French military base and settled into formation at the start of a 40-day flight taking them through the icy Arctic and steamy tropics before ending in a desert.

The aircraft left Istres air base in southern France and will travel 40,000 kilometres, cross three continents and make nine stopovers, working with international partners along the route to demonstrate the value of alliances at a time when big powers such as China and the US seem determined to go it alone.



Members of ‘Russian Community’ organisation during a religion procession, in St. Petersburg, Saturday AP/PTI

Nepal floods: Death toll rises to 1,386

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA  
Kathmandu, September 12

The death toll in Nepal due to the flash floods rose to 1,386 on Saturday as more bodies were recovered from the eight affected districts, authorities said.

The flash floods, triggered by an ice-rock avalanche near the Nepal-Tibet border on August 26, devastated towns and villages in northern and central Nepal.

According to the latest data released by the National Disaster Risk Reduction and Management Authority on Saturday, 185 bodies were recovered in Rasuwa, 199 in Nuwakot, 70 in Dhading, 77 in Gorkha, and 38 in Tanahun.

In Chitwan, 364 bodies were recovered, 229 in Nawalparasi East and 222 in Nawalparasi West.

Two other people died while undergoing treatment in Kathmandu. Only 104 of the recovered bodies have so far been identified and handed over to their families.

PUTIN WARNS EUROPE AGAINST SENDING TROOPS

Russian strikes on Ukraine kill five

ASSOCIATED PRESS  
Kyiv, September 12

Russian strikes killed five civilians and wounded dozens in Ukraine, local officials said Saturday, after Russian President Vladimir Putin warned that sending European troops into Ukraine would amount to direct conflict with Russia.

Ukraine is under mounting pressure from Russia’s intensifying air campaign that uses ballistic missiles and jet-powered drones to pierce defences. Moscow’s attacks have targeted Ukraine’s power grid ahead of winter in what officials say is meant to demoralise civilians.

Two people were killed and one wounded when Russian drones struck a residential area overnight in the Ukrainian city of Zaporizhzhia, regional head Ivan Fedorov said Saturday.

One person died and three others were wounded



A civilian reacts after a gas station was hit by a Russian drone in Kyiv, Ukraine AP/PTI

in strikes on Kryvyi Rih, according to local officials.

In the Black Sea port of Odesa and the surrounding area, 35 people were wounded overnight in what regional head Oleh Kiper called a “massive

attack.” Among the buildings hit was a residential high-rise, whose upper floors were completely destroyed.

Later on Saturday, two people were killed in a Russian attack on a grocery store in Ukraine’s Zhytomyr region, local officials said. Meanwhile, Ukrainian President Volodymyr Zelenskyy said Ukrainian forces struck two chemical industry facilities in Russia, one in

Samara and one in Perm.

The governors of the regions did not immediately comment, but Russian independent online news outlet Astra reported drone attacks on chemical plants in both regions.

Prison riot and fire in northern Syrian town kills at least seven

On Friday, riots broke out in Kobani after Kurds blamed Arabs for killing a Kurdish man

ASSOCIATED PRESS  
Damascus, September 12

A fire and riot broke out in a prison in a predominantly Kurdish town in northern Syria on Saturday, killing at least seven people, state media reported.

The SANA news agency said the fire started when inmates in the Kobani prison rioted over tensions that erupted in the town the previous day between Kurds and Arabs.

The prison is still run by Kurdish fighters even though Syrian government forces entered the town along the border with Türkiye recently.

The Britain-based Syrian Observatory for Human Rights, a war mon-

itor, said the riots started over plans by authorities to transfer some inmates to a prison in the northern city of Aleppo.

Kobani, which had been under siege by the Islamic State group a decade ago, became a springboard for a US-backed Kurdish offensive that ended with the extremists losing the last sliver of land they once held in 2019.

On Friday, riots broke out in Kobani after Kurds blamed Arabs for killing a Kurdish man.

Tensions between the Kurdish minority and the central government remain high despite recent moves to bring northeast Syria under the control of the new government in Damascus.

SPORT

SHELTON PULLED OUT A 4-6, 6-3, 6-3, 7-5 VICTORY

Ben Shelton beats Frances Tiafoe, will play Zverev for US Open title

ASSOCIATED PRESS  
New York, September 12

Ben Shelton and Frances Tiafoe had a packed crowd sprinkled with celebrities cheering equally for them, as the two fan favorites fought to reach their first major final.

The crowd figures to be almost entirely on Shelton’s side Sunday, because now he’s the American hope to end a lengthy Grand Slam drought.

Shelton pulled out a 4-6, 6-3, 6-3, 7-5 victory on Friday and will play No.



1 seed Alexander Zverev on for the U.S. Open title. The host nation hasn’t had a men’s major winner

since Andy Roddick won in Flushing Meadows in 2003. “I’m going for it here, and I’m going to leave it all

on the court,” Shelton said. “I hope you guys come and back me. Let’s do it for the USA.”

The No. 8-seeded Shelton had plenty of energy left after ousting defending champion Carlos Alcaraz in a quarterfinal match that ended Wednesday at 3:33 a.m., the latest finish ever at the U.S. Open.

Now he needs to stop the French Open champion, who knows what’s at stake for the other side.

“Hopefully I can not make the American dream come true on Sunday,” Zverev said. Zverev beat Karen Khachanov 6-3, 7-6 (7), 7-6 (6) in the first semifinal.

KEY POINTS

- » ‘I’m going for it here, and I’m going to leave it all on the court,’ Shelton said. ‘I hope you guys come & back me’
- » ‘Hopefully I can not make the American dream come true on Sunday,’ Zverev said. Zverev beat Karen Khachanov 6-3, 7-6 (7), 7-6 (6) in the first semifinal.

INDIA BEAT SOUTH KOREA 5-1

Supriya’s hat-trick takes India to Junior Women’s Asia Cup final

AGENCIES  
Moqi, September 12

Drag-flick specialist Supriya put up a fine show as the Indian women’s team entered the final of the AHF Junior Asia Cup with a convincing 5-1 victory over South Korea in the first semifinal here on Saturday.

India will now face the winner of the second semifinal between hosts China and Japan in the summit clash. Both teams began cautiously, with the intensity of the knockout encounter leading to a cagey opening phase.

India gradually settled into their rhythm and began

creating openings, eventually breaking the deadlock in the 13th minute. A well-constructed attacking move saw Madhu Sidar provide the finishing touch to give India a 1-0 lead.

The goal gave India added momentum and they began dictating proceedings in the second quarter, making regular incursions into the Korean circle.

Their pressure earned a penalty corner in the 17th minute, and Supriya stepped up to unleash a precise drag-flick past the Korean defence and double India’s advantage. India continued to control possession and territory, and

their attacking intent was rewarded again in the 21st minute. A superbly directed aerial ball into the Korean 23-metre area found an Indian winger, whose well-timed cross into the circle was expertly finished by Sukhveer Kaur to make it 3-0.

Supriya converted another penalty corner to put India 4-0 ahead, before Yuri Jeong pulled one back for South Korea in the 41st minute.

India stayed disciplined thereafter, while Supriya completed her hat-trick from another penalty corner in the 56th minute to seal a 5-1 win.

India face Samson-Sooryavanshi dilemma vs Afghanistan  
Both could benefit from opportunities against Afghanistan’s strong attack

AGENCIES  
New Delhi, September 12

India face a selection dilemma over explosive teenager Vaibhav Sooryavanshi and experienced Sanju Samson as they open their three-match T20I series against Afghanistan on Sunday. Sooryavanshi replaced Samson in the playing XI during the England series, but the 15-year-old eventually made way for his senior partner in the final match.

With the Asian Games approaching, both could benefit from opportunities against Afghanistan’s strong attack. Sooryavan-



shi’s aggressive game could prove effective against an Afghan bowling unit that lacks the pace and movement of Jasprit Bumrah. Samson, meanwhile,

CLOSER LOOK

- » Both could feature if Ishan Kishan, who had a back injury scare during practice, is ruled out
- » Sooryavanshi’s aggressive game could prove effective against an Afghan bowling
- » India must also decide between specialist spinner Varun Chakravathy and seamer Yash Thakur

back injury scare during practice, is ruled out. Kishan enters the series after scoring 270 and 80 in the Duleep Trophy final.

The series will provide

valuable preparation for India ahead of the Asian Games, with Afghanistan boasting a formidable spin attack led by Rashid Khan, Noor Ahmed & Mujeeb ur Rahman. Their pace unit includes Fazalhaq Farooqi & Naveen-ul-Haq, while all-rounders Gulbadin Naib and Azmatullah Omarzai add depth.

Beyond the opening dilemma, India must decide between specialist spinner Varun Chakravathy & seamer Yash Thakur. Axar Patel & Washington Sundar are expected to feature alongside pace duo Bumrah & Arshdeep and all-rounder Nitish Kumar Reddy.

Government of Jammu & Kashmir  
OFFICE OF THE EXECUTIVE ENGINEER MECHANICAL & HOSPITALSDIVISION SRINAGAR  
Telefax:- 0194-2496089,  
Gist of e-tender  
e-NIT No: M&HDS/TS /2026-27/58/e-tendering,  
Dated: 11.09.2026

For and on behalf of the Lt. Governor, J&K UT e-tenders are invited on percentage basis from registered/reputed/experienced firms with J&K State Govt., CPWD, Railways and other State/Central Governments for the below mentioned work:

| Name of Work                                                                                                                                                                                                        | Est. Cost (in lacs) | Cost of T/Doc. | Time of completion (in days) | TS No                        | Earnest Money            |
|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------|----------------|------------------------------|------------------------------|--------------------------|
| 1.Replacement of old damaged panel by way of supply , installation, testing and commissioning of floor mounted power distribution electric control panel for boiler house at govt. bone & joint hospital, srinagar. | 3.70                | 200            | 30                           | M&HDS/ TS/48 Dated:- 09/2026 | 2% of the estimated cost |
| 2.Electricals/Works pertaining to Central Heating System installes at Govt.SMHS Hospital Srinagar for the year 2027-27                                                                                              | 1.90745             | 200            | 30                           | M&HDS/ TS/49 Dated:- 09/2026 | 2% of the estimated cost |

AA Accorded Vide No: 07 MCS of 2026 Dt:23.04.2026.  
Position of Funds:- Available with intending Department.  
1. Downloading of Bids:- The NIT consisting of qualifying information, eligibility criteria, specifications, Bill of quantities (B.O.Q), Set of terms and conditions of contract and other details can be seen from the departmental website www.jktenders.gov.in from 11.09.2026(18.00 hrs) and can be downloaded from 11.09.2026(18.00 hrs)  
2. Uploading: The bidders shall deposit their bids in electronic format on the above web site 11.09.2026(18.00 hrs) to 22.09.2026 (13:00hrs ) in two (02) covers.  
3. Opening of Bids :- The bids received upto due date and time shall be opened on 22.09.2026 at 15.00(hrs)  
No: M&HDS/TS/3750-54 Dated:11.09.2026  
DIP No:DIPK-5624/26

Sd/- Ecutive Engineer,  
M&HD, Srinagar

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 82 Cr.P.C.

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused **Narender @ Gauri**, S/o: Mahender, R/o: H.No. 34, Gali No. 10, A-1 Block, Bengali Colony, Burari, Delhi has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case **FIR No. 29/2018, U/s 308/323/325/342/34 IPC, P.S.: Burari, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused **Narender @ Gauri** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Narender @ Gauri** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said **Narender @ Gauri** accused of offence in case **FIR No. 29/2018, U/s 308/323/325/342/34 IPC, P.S.: Burari, Delhi** and is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **16.10.2026**.

By Order  
**Sh. Virender Kumar Kharta**  
Additional Sessions Judge (FTC)-2  
Room No. 266, Tis Hazari Court, Delhi

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON (See Section 82 Cr.PC)

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused **Ravi Kant**, S/o Ranbir Singh R/o H.No.33, Ishwar Colony, Near Daya Basti, Bawana, Delhi has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case **FIR No.04/2017 u/s 33/52 Excise Act, P.S. Vivek Vihar, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused **Ravi Kant** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Ravi Kant** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused **Ravi Kant** of **FIR No.04/2017 u/s 33/52 Excise Act, P.S. Vivek Vihar, Delhi** is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **22.10.2026**.

By Order  
**Sh. Mohit Sharma**  
Chief Judicial Magistrate, Room No.59  
Third Floor, Shahdara District  
Karkardooma Courts, Delhi

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON (SEE SECTION 82(2) (ii) Cr.P.C./84 BNSS)

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused person(s) **Rahul @ Gogi S/o Raja Ram R/o Village Mangol Patti, Post Cheeka, Distt, Kaithal, Haryana-136034** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case **FIR No. 836/2025, U/s 262 Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita, PS IGI Airport, New Delhi** and it has been returned to a Warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused person(s) **Rahul @ Gogi** can not be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused person(s) **Rahul @ Gogi** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused person(s) **Rahul @ Gogi** of case **FIR No. 836/2025, U/s 262 Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita, PS IGI Airport, New Delhi** is required to appear before this court to answer the said complaint on or before dated **14.10.2026**.

By Order  
**Animesh Bhaskar Mani Tripathi**  
Add. Chief Judicial Magistrate-01  
Court No. 02, Ground Floor  
Patiala House Courts, New Delhi

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 82 Cr.P.C.

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused **Guddi**, W/o: Fakru, R/o: H. No. B-741, Mangolpuri, Delhi has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case **FIR No. 718/19, U/s 38 Ex. Act & 129/55 Gambling Act, P.S.: Raj Park, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused **Guddi** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Guddi** has absconded (or is concealing herself to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said **Guddi** accused of offence in case **FIR No. 718/19, U/s 38 Ex. Act & 129/55 Gambling Act, P.S.: Raj Park, Delhi** and is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **22.10.2026**.

By Order  
**Ms. Aakanksha**  
Judicial Magistrate First Class-03  
Room No. 107, Rohini Court, Delhi

झारखण्ड सरकार  
पथ निर्माण विभाग, पथ प्रमण्डल, गिरिडीह

ई-प्रोक्वोरमेंट सूचना  
(प्रथम निविदा आमंत्रण सूचना)

ई-निविदा प्रसंग सं० :- RCD/GIRIDIH/ 1086/2026-27  
दिनांक :- 09.09.2026

|    |                                                 |                                                                                                                           |
|----|-------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 1. | कार्य का नाम                                    | तिसरी थानसिंहडीह पथ में चंदोरी बाईपास पथ (कुल लंबाई - 0.725 कि०मी०) के निर्माण कार्य (Utility Shifting सहित) वर्ष 2026-27 |
| 2. | प्राक्कलित राशि (रुपये में)                     | रु० 3,37,35,743.00 (तीन करोड़ सैंतीस लाख पैंतीस हजार सात सौ तैंतालीस रुपये मात्र)                                         |
| 3. | कार्य समाप्ति की अवधि                           | 04 (चार) माह                                                                                                              |
| 4. | निविदा प्राप्ति की अंतिम तिथि एवं समय           | 06.10.2026 12:00 बजे दिन तक                                                                                               |
| 5. | वेबसाईट पर निविदा प्रकाशित होने की तिथि एवं समय | 15.09.2026 10:30 बजे पूर्वाह्न एवं समय                                                                                    |
| 6. | निविदा आमंत्रित करने वाले का नाम एवं पता        | कार्यपालक अभियंता का कार्यालय, पथ निर्माण विभाग, पथ प्रमण्डल, गिरिडीह।                                                    |
| 7. | प्रोक्वोरमेंट पदाधिकारी का सम्पर्क नं०          | 06532 - 227054                                                                                                            |
| 8. | ई-प्रोक्वोरमेंट सेल का हेल्प लाईन नं०           | 0651 - 2401010                                                                                                            |

अतिरिक्त जानकारी के लिए वेबसाईट पर देखें :- <http://jharkhandtenders.gov.in>

ह०/-  
कार्यपालक अभियंता,  
PR 389617 Road(26-27)#D पथ निर्माण विभाग, पथ प्रमण्डल, गिरिडीह

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 84 Bhartiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused **Lokesh Yadav** S/o Late Albel Singh R/o F-237, Gali No.11, Molarband Extension, Badarpur, New Delhi has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence **FIR No. 148/2026 u/s 20/61/85 NDPS Act at P.S. Badarpur, New Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said **Lokesh Yadav** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said **Lokesh Yadav** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proceeding u/s **84 Bhartiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita** has been initiated in the case. Proclamation is hereby made that the said **Lokesh Yadav** accused of **FIR No. 148/2026 u/s 20/61/85 NDPS Act at P.S. Badarpur, New Delhi** is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **04.11.2026**.

By Order: **Shri Kumar Rajat**,  
Additional Sessions Judge-04/Special Judge (NDPS),  
Court No. 312, South-East Distt.,  
Saket Courts, New Delhi.

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 84 Bharatiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita, 2023

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused **Joginder @ Tiger**, S/o: Manjeet Singh @ Dholiya, R/o: H.No. 541, D-Block, Inderpuri, New Delhi has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case **FIR No. 44/2026, U/s 21/25/29 NDPS Act, P.S.: Inderpuri, New Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused **Joginder @ Tiger** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Joginder @ Tiger** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said **Joginder @ Tiger** accused of offence in case **FIR No. 44/2026, U/s 21/25/29 NDPS Act, P.S.: Inderpuri, New Delhi** and is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **17.10.2026**.

By Order  
**Sh. Bhupinder Singh**  
Special Judge, NDPS  
Room No. 702, Rouse Avenue Court, New Delhi

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 82 Cr.P.C.

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused **Shikha @ Muskan**, D/o: Dharmvir @ Mohd. Sahid, R/o: B-84 Jwala Puri, Delhi-110087 also at **Amar Puri, Nabi Karim, Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case **FIR No.: 373/2022, U/s: 379/34 IPC, P.S. Burari, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said **Shikha @ Muskan** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said **Shikha @ Muskan** has absconded (or is concealing herself to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused **Shikha @ Muskan** of **P.S. Burari, Delhi** is required to appear before this court to answer the said complaint on or before **15.10.2026**.

By Order  
**Ms. Payal Singal**  
JMFC-09, Central Distt., Room No. 286,  
Tis Hazari Courts, Delhi

NORTH CENTRAL RAILWAY

Letter No:-DRM/C/AGRA/NFRE-AUCTION Date: 10.09.2026

Category: Misc- Static- Services Catalogue No. RCR-MT-J-26-01

Asset Details

Contract for Operation & Maintenance of Rail Coach Restaurant at Circulating area of Mathura Junction railway Station.

E-Auction Start Date and Time : Date:- 22.09.2026 Time:- 11:00

E-Auction End Date and Time : Date:- 22.09.2026 Time:- 11:30

Category: ADVT Catalogue No. ADVT-AGRA-26-08

Asset Details

Commercial Publicity via Glowsign/Board at Platform & Concourse area of Raja Ki Mandi Railway Station zone 1st.

E-Auction Start Date and Time : Date:- 23.09.2026 Time:- 11:00

E-Auction End Date and Time : Date:- 23.09.2026 Time:- 11:30

Commercial Publicity via Hoarding/Unipole near LC Gate no. 57 of Nadabai Railway Station.

E-Auction Start Date and Time : Date:- 23.09.2026 Time:- 11:10

E-Auction End Date and Time : Date:- 23.09.2026 Time:- 11:40

Commercial Publicity via Backlit at Circulating area of Agra Cantt. Railway Station.

E-Auction Start Date and Time : Date:- 23.09.2026 Time:- 11:20

E-Auction End Date and Time : Date:- 23.09.2026 Time:- 11:50

Commercial Publicity via Backlit at Circulating area of Mathura Jn. Railway Station.

E-Auction Start Date and Time : Date:- 23.09.2026 Time:- 11:30

E-Auction End Date and Time : Date:- 23.09.2026 Time:- 12:00

Note:- Prospective bidders are required to visit E-Auction Leasing Module on IREPS website ([www.ireps.gov.in](http://www.ireps.gov.in)). The Lot-wise details are available therein under the above mentioned Catalogue Number. 2076/26 (MG)

North central railways @CPRONCR [www.ncr.indianrailways.gov.in](http://www.ncr.indianrailways.gov.in)

EAST CENTRAL RAILWAY E-TENDER NOTICE

For and on behalf of the President of India, E-Tender on "Single Packet System" are invited from the Firms/Agencies/ Contractors of repute having technical expertise and financial solvency for the following works.

(i) GeM Bid No. & Date: e-tender Notice No. MC-09-Open-2026-27 Dated : 10.09.2026.  
(ii) Name of work its location and completion period : Work of CAMC for out of warranty coaches & periodical maintenance of under warranty coaches of pneumatic pressurized flushing system (PPFS) and Electro Pneumatic Pressurized Flushing System (EPPFS) installed in LHB Coaches at DHN Coaching Depot for the period of 3 years and Supply, laying of Epoxy flooring in LWACCW, LWACCN, LWACCNE, LWSCN, LWSLS and LWSCZAC type LHB coaches at Coaching depot, DHN for 3 years. Completion period - 03 years. (iii) Approx. Cost of the work : ₹4,25,85,044.16 (Rupees Four crore twenty-five lakh eight-five thousand forty-four and sixteen paise) only. (iv) Earnest Money to be deposited : ₹8,51,700/- (Rupees Eight lakh fifty-one thousand seven hundred) only. (v) Date & time for closing of e-tender : 17.00 hrs. on 01.10.2026. Date & time for opening for e-tender : 17.30 hrs. on 01.10.2026. (vi) Website particulars:<https://www.ireps.gov.in>  
No manual tender will be accepted against e-tendering. Divisional Railway Manager/ ECR/Dhanbad PR/0900/DHN/MECH/T/26-27/44

**CHANGE OF NAME**  
**I, Ashoka Arora S/o, Kishan Singh R/o, J-9, UGF, Krishna Nagar, PO Krishna Nagar, Distt. East Delhi, Delhi-110051.** That my Actual & correct name is **ASHOKA ARORA**. That in my name as **Ashok Kumar Arora** and **Ashoka Arora** is one and same person. That in future my name will be known as **ASHOKA ARORA** for all purposes.

**I, Babloo Khan S/o, Sher Khan R/o, D-40, D-Block, D.D.A Colony, new Jafraabad, Shahdra, North East Delhi, Delhi-110032.** That my actual & correct name is **BABLOO KHAN**. That in my name as **Bablu Khan** and **Babloo Khan** is one and same person. That in future my name will be known as **BABLOO KHAN** for all purposes.

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 82 Cr.P.C.

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused **Geeta @ Pooja**, D/o: Ram Chander, R/o: H.No. Jhuggi No. 76/47, Dhoobi Ghat, New Om Nagar, Sangam Park, Rana Pratap Bagh, Delhi has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case **FIR No. 496/2023 U/s 380 IPC, P.S.: Vivek Vihar, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused **Geeta @ Pooja** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Geeta @ Pooja** has absconded (or is concealing herself to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said **Geeta @ Pooja** accused of offence in case **FIR No. 496/2023 U/s 380 IPC, P.S.: Vivek Vihar, Delhi** and is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **12.10.2026**.

By Order  
**Sh. Mohit Sharma**  
Chief Judicial Magistrate,  
Room No. 59, Shahdara,  
Karkardooma Court, Delhi

NORTH CENTRAL RAILWAY

E-Procurement Tender Notice No. 26/43 Date : 11.09.2026  
E-Procurement Tender Notice  
On behalf of the President of India, The Principal Chief Materials Manager, North Central Railway, Prayagraj, (An ISO 9001:2015 certified unit) invites the following E-Procurement Tenders.

| Tender No. | Short Description                                                                                                       | Qty.           | Tender Opening Date |
|------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------|---------------------|
| 70261817   | Bolt M.S. black hex head round body without nuts                                                                        | 82661 Kgs      | 19.11.2026          |
| 60255022A  | scissorslift 450 Kg.                                                                                                    | 5 Nos.         | 19.10.2026          |
| 60265027   | 5 (Five) Ton capacity Diesel Hydraulic Rail Crane.                                                                      | 1 Nos.         | 21.10.2026          |
| 6326RGCG17 | This is tender to enter in to Running Contract for Manufacture and Supply of Elastic Rail Clip MK-V Drg. No.RD50 T-S919 | 1, 45, 48, 762 | 21.OCT.26           |

Note : The complete information of above tenders can be seen and downloaded from IREPS website i.e. <https://www.ireps.gov.in>. For any change/corrigendum in tender, please visit this website regularly. No. separate corrigendum/change will be published in news paper. 2079/26 (C)

North central railways [www.ncr.indianrailways.gov.in](http://www.ncr.indianrailways.gov.in) @CPRONC

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED

See Section 82 Cr.P.C.

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused **Rahul Kumar Sahni**, S/o Raghuraj Sahni R/o H.No. D-480, Qutub Vihar Phase-II, South Dwarka, Delhi has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence Case **E-FIR No. 11218/18 u/s 379/411/34 IPC at P.S. Kalyanpuri, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said **Rahul Kumar Sahni** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said **Rahul Kumar Sahni** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proceeding u/s **82 Cr.P.C.** has been initiated in the case. Proclamation is hereby made that the said **Rahul Kumar Sahni** accused of **E-FIR No. 11218/18 u/s 379/411/34 IPC at P.S. Kalyanpuri, Delhi** is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **14.10.2026**.

By Order: **Prigya Gupta**,  
Judicial Magistrate First Class,  
East Distt., Room No. 29,  
Karkardooma Courts, Delhi.

DP/12944/ED/2026

NORTH CENTRAL RAILWAY E-TENDERING TENDER NOTICE

E-Tender No.: JHS-ENGG-HQ-2026-204 Dated: 10.09.2026  
Divisional Railway Manager (Works) North Central Railway, Jhansi for and behalf of President of India invites sealed "Open Tender" through on Line (E-Tendering) for the following work.

Description of Work: Construction of Soak pits/RWH at JHS/E, JHS/W, MSV, GRM, PIC, CGN, NDK, MOTH & ERC under DEN/HQ/JHS jurisdiction.

Approx Cost: ₹ 12396873.35 Earnest Money : ₹ 247900.00

Date of Closing Tender: 05.10.2026 at 15:00 hrs.

Date of completion / period from issue acceptance letter: 12 Months.

Tender on line can be submitted up to 15:00 hrs. on 05.10.2026.

For full details and submission of bid please see the Indian Railways website [www.ireps.gov.in](http://www.ireps.gov.in). 2075/26 (A)

North central railways @CPRONCR [www.ncr.indianrailways.gov.in](http://www.ncr.indianrailways.gov.in)

DISTRICT POLICE HEADQUARTERS SAMBA "Look-Out Notice"

As intimated by SDPO Bari-Brahmana vide letter No. SDPO/BB/26/7987 dated 09.09.2026, that one person namely **HasseenaBano D/o MohdSahid R/o U.P A/P TelliBasti Bari Brahmanah** has been missing from Bari-Brahmana and her missing report has been entered vide DDR No.12 dated 27.01.2025 of P/S Bari-Brahmana. Her search was conducted but not traced out till date. Through the medium of this LOOK OUT NOTICE, it is informed to all the Police Establishments/General Public that any information related to the missing person may be communicated on following contacts:-

As such, a look-out notice of above mentioned girl is being published/telecast on Print/Electronic media for information of Police Establishments so that they could be identified and any information related to her may be communicated on following contacts:-

- PCR Samba:- 01923-246333, 9541649001
- SSP Samba's email ID :- [sspsamba@jkpolice.gov.in](mailto:sspsamba@jkpolice.gov.in)
- SHO PS Bari-Brahmana:- 8713023636

|                                                                            |                                     |
|----------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------|
| The description roll along with photograph of missing person is as under:- |                                     |
| Name:                                                                      | Hasseena Bano                       |
| D/O:                                                                       | MohdSahid                           |
| Permanent Address:                                                         | U.P A/P TelliBasti Bari Brahmana    |
| Age:                                                                       | 18 Years                            |
| Height:                                                                    | 5 FEET 04INCH                       |
| Complexion:                                                                | Wheatish                            |
| Face:                                                                      | ROUND                               |
| Body Structure:                                                            | Medium                              |
| Languages known:                                                           | HINDI                               |
| Attire:                                                                    | SalwarKameez Blue Colour            |
| No. CB/Look/2026/ Dated: -                                                 | 09.2026                             |
| Sd/-                                                                       | Sr. Superintendent of Police, Samba |
| DIP No:DIP/J-10254/26                                                      |                                     |

NORTH CENTRAL RAILWAY E-Tendering Tender Notice

No.- Jhansi/W/T/Tender General/202 Date: 10.09.2026  
Divisional Railway Manager (Works) North Central Railway, Jhansi for and behalf of President of India invites sealed "Open Tender" through on Line (E-Tendering) for the following work.

E-Tender No.:JHS-ENGG-N-2026-202 Approx Cost: 45321258.65  
Description of work: Rehabilitation including seepage protection of RUBs to prevent water logging underADEN/LINE jurisdiction in VGLJ-STLI Section & Provision of Sump Well and Drainage Improvement at LHS in VGLJ-STLI Section under ADEN/LINE jurisdiction.

Earnest Money: 906400.00 Date of closing Tender: 05/10/2026 at 15:00 hrs.

Date of Completion/period from issue acceptance letter: 12 Months.

Tender online can be submitted up to 15:00 hrs. on 05.10.2026. For full details and submission of bid please see the Indian Railways website [www.ireps.gov.in](http://www.ireps.gov.in)

North central railways [www.ncr.indianrailways.gov.in](http://www.ncr.indianrailways.gov.in) @CPRONCR 2074/26 (K)

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 84 Bharatiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita, 2023

Whereas complaint has been made before me that the accused **Amit @ Bittu**, S/o. Naresh Kumar, R/o. H.No. E-712, Talab Wali Gali, Babarpur, Welcome, Delhi has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in a case vide **FIR No. 219/2019 U/S 506/326 IPC** registered at **P.S Welcome, North East District, Delhi** and it has been returned on a warrant of arrest there upon issued stating that the said accused **Amit @ Bittu** could not be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that accused **Amit @ Bittu** is absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said **Amit @ Bittu**, accused of **FIR No. 219/2019 U/S 506/326 IPC, P.S Welcome, North East District, Delhi** is required to appear before the court to answer the said complaint on or before **27.10.2026**.

By Order, **Deepakshi Rana**,  
Judicial Magistrate First Class-03,  
DP/12870/NE/2026 Shahdara District, Room No.19, First Floor,  
(Court Matter) Karkardooma Courts, Delhi.

NORTH CENTRAL RAILWAY E-Tender Notice

Tender Notice No. 7220262027-155 Dated: 09.09.2026  
Divisional Railway Manager (Engineering)/ North Central Railway/ Prayagraj, for and on behalf of the President of India, invites the following E-Tenders on prescribed form for the following works up to 13:30 hrs. On 07.10.2026. The details of the tenders are as under:

Tender No.: 155 Approx. Cost of work (₹): ₹ 8,24,38,786.8

Name of work: Providing and erecting "W" metal cattle, barrier for sealing of remaining patches to prevent CRO in connection with increasing speed upto 160 KMPH in the DDU-PRYJ section under Sr. DEN/II/PRYJ.

Bid security (₹) : ₹ 16,48,800.00 Completion Period : 4 months

Date of Opening of tender : 07.10.2026

Similar work for Eligibility Criteria : Any Civil Engineering work.

Note: 1. The complete information along with tender document of above E-Tenders is available on website [www.ireps.gov.in](http://www.ireps.gov.in) up to 13:30 hrs. on the due date of tender opening i.e. 07.10.2026. The tender shall be opened at or after 15:00 hrs on due date of opening. 2. Bids other than in the form of E-Bids shall not be accepted against above Tenders. For this purpose, vendors are required to get themselves registered with IREPS website along with Digital Signature Certificates issued by CCA under IT Act-2000. 3. Rates entered into Financial Rate page and duly signed digitally shall be considered. Rates and any other financial entity in any other form/letter head if attached by vendors shall be straightaway ignored and shall not be considered. 4. Tender No. 155 are having advertised value more than 50 Lakhs, therefore, Annexure-V & V(A) (Document Verification Certificate) is required. The supplier/contractor of goods and/or services would be subject to GST Act and Rules as applicable from time to time. 5. This tender notice has also been uploaded on [www.ncr.indianrailways.gov.in](http://www.ncr.indianrailways.gov.in). 6. In case of any difficulty helpline available on the website of IREPS may be approached. 7. Tender online can be submitted up to 13:30 hrs. on 07.10.2026. 8. E-Tender Forms shall be issued free of cost to all tenderers. 9. For tender no. 155: The tenderers have to submit necessary documents in compliance of clause 10 to 18 (Part-1) of IRGCC-2022 (Works matter) mandatorily, otherwise their offer will be considered as incomplete offer and accordingly shall not be considered. 2077/26(AK)

North central railways @CPRONCR [www.ncr.indianrailways.gov.in](http://www.ncr.indianrailways.gov.in)

UNION TERRITORY OF JAMMU & KASHMIR OFFICE THE EXECUTIVE ENGINEER PWD (R&B) PROJECT DIVISION- III, JAMMU SHORT NOTICE INVITING TENDER

Short e-NIT No. 64 of 2026-2027 Dated 11-09-2026  
For and on behalf of the Lieutenant Governor, Union Territory of Jammu and Kashmir e-tenders are invited on percentage basis from approved and eligible Contractors registered with Union Territory of J&K, CPWD, Railways, MES and other State/Central Governments for each of the following works :-

| S. No | Name of Work | Name of Division |
|-------|--------------|------------------|
|-------|--------------|------------------|

# THE PEOPLE WE ASK TO ENTER HELL



*A country that has sent spacecraft to the Moon, processes billions of digital payments and aspires to soon become a \$5-trillion economy still sends human beings into sewers. What does that say about the India that we have built?*

MPPOST BUREAU

It is a job nobody should have. Imagine climbing down into a sewer. There is no sunlight. And barely any room. The air is foul, heavy and poisonous. You have a shovel, a bucket and a few rudimentary tools. You are wearing whatever protection is available, if at all. Around you is everything a city has flushed away, discarded and forgotten. You are expected to clean it. Not with a machine operated from a safe distance. Not with a robot. Not with a sophisticated piece of equipment designed to keep a human being out of harm's way. You. Only you.

For hours, you work in an environment into which nobody should put a hand, leave alone a body. You breathe air that no human being should have to breathe. When the work is over, you climb into the sunlight and go home with your meagre earnings. Sometimes, you do not go back at all. The image is despicable, because it is not a scene from India's past. It is not a description of a primitive sanitation system that disappeared with the arrival of today's cities. It is happening in India now.

In July, Parliament was informed that 332 sanitation workers died across the country between January 2021 and June 2026 while undertaking hazardous cleaning of sewers and septic tanks. In all, 193 FIRs had been registered against agencies and officials for hazardous manual cleaning. 332 people. Not a statistic. For it involves 332 families whose lives changed because somebody had to enter a place that any modern civilisation should have made inaccessible to human beings.

### Official Paradox

There is a paradox in the official story. In August, the Rajya Sabha was told that a fresh nationwide survey had identified no manual scavengers. It also said that 89,915 sewer and septic-tank workers had been validated under the National Action for Mechanised Sanitation Ecosystem, or NAMASTE. Technically, there is a distinction. Under a law passed in 2013, manual scavenging refers to manually cleaning and carrying human excreta from insanitary latrines and other places. Hazardous cleaning of sewers and septic tanks is separately prohibited under the same legal framework.

But for the family of a worker who dies after entering a sewer,

the distinction must seem almost surreal. He did not die because a dictionary definition was inadequate. He died because a human being was sent into a place where a machine should have gone. That is the failure we should be discussing.

### A Job We Outgrew

India has changed dramatically in the past few decades. We have built metros and expressways. We have put spacecraft on the Moon. We have created the world's largest digital-payment ecosystem.



44,217 TO ZERO?

A 2018 SURVEY IDENTIFIED 44,217 MANUAL SCAVENGERS ACROSS 14 STATES. THE GOVERNMENT'S LATEST NATIONWIDE SURVEY NOW REPORTS ZERO MANUAL SCAVENGERS

We speak of artificial intelligence, semiconductor manufacturing, electric vehicles and becoming a developed economy. We have become very good at eliminating inconvenience for the consumer.

Yet, somewhere behind the apartment towers and shopping malls, behind the smart cities and digital dashboards, there remains a person with a shovel being asked to clean what the rest of us have flushed away. This is not merely a sanitation problem. It is a technological failure. It is an administrative failure. It is an enforcement failure. And ultimately, it is a failure of imagination.

For the solution is not mysterious. The rest of the world has long understood that hazardous sanitation work must be mechanised. India understands it too. NAMASTE is designed around mechanisation and the elimination of hazardous manual cleaning. By 2025-end, 89,000 sewer and septic-tank workers had been validated under the scheme. Then why, after all these years, does a human body remain part of the equipment?

INDIA HAS LAWS, MACHINES AND MONEY TO END MANUAL SCAVENGING. WHAT IT LACKS IS THE RESOLVE TO ENSURE THAT NO HUMAN BEING ENTERS A SEWER SCAVENGING

### The Caste We Ignore

There is another truth. An uncomfortable one. Manual scavenging has never been only about sewage. It has also been about caste. For generations, some of India's most degrading sanitation tasks have been pushed towards communities at the bottom of the social hierarchy. Much of the work became hereditary. Not because it was dignified or desirable, but because society decided that someone else should do it. And that history cannot be wished away by changing the terminology.

The law has been around for years. The 'Prohibition of Employment as Manual Scavengers and their Rehabilitation Act' was passed in 2013. It bans the employment or engagement of manual scavengers and provides penalties for violations. In 2023, the Supreme Court stepped in, raising the compensation for sewer deaths to Rs 30 lakh and ordered that sewer cleaning be completely eradicated.

Yet, the deaths continue. That, perhaps, is the damning part. India does not lack laws against this work. It lacks the ability and the administrative will to ensure that the law reaches the bottom of the drain.

### Ask Who Cleans It

On September 1, at the Press Club of India, Delhi, sanitation workers and their families from four states gathered under the banner 'India at 80: End Manual Scavenging', insisting that the practice has not disappeared. They were there not as statistics but as people, carrying stories of a 'job role' that the country would rather believe has already ended.

That is worth pausing over. India will soon be 80 years old as an independent nation. Eighty years. And there are still people whose occupation involves dealing manually with the most basic waste produced by human existence. So, what are we celebrating when we talk about India's transformation?

A \$4-trillion economy is an impressive economic milestone. But GDP cannot measure dignity. A new highway cannot tell us whether the worker cleaning the drain beneath it is safe. A digital-payment record cannot tell us whether the person who cleaned the sewage system has gloves, protective equipment or a machine to do the job. Development is not simply about what a country can build. It is also about what it refuses to make a human being do.

There is another reason this subject makes us uncomfortable. Most of us do not see the sanitation worker. We flush the toilet and the waste disappears. We close the bathroom door. The smell goes away. The drain clears. You and the city carry on. Somebody else deals with what we have produced. That distance has allowed an extraordinary moral arrangement to survive: one person can enjoy sanitation because another person is prepared to enter its most dangerous underside.

+ NO EVALUATION

THE CENTRE TOLD PARLIAMENT IN JULY 2026 THAT NO SEPARATE EVALUATION HAD BEEN UNDERTAKEN ON THE IMPLEMENTATION OF MECHANISED SEWER CLEANING ACROSS STATES AND UTS

### No Excuse Left

There is no argument left for this. Not in a country that has the engineering capability to automate factories, perform robotic surgery, build sophisticated spacecraft and deploy machines into places where humans cannot safely go. Sewer cleaning is not beyond India's technological capacity. It is beyond India's tolerance that it should still require a human body.

The Government has begun mechanisation under NAMASTE, including profiling workers, distributing protective equipment and promoting sanitation enterprises. PPE kits have also been distributed. But protective equipment should never become an excuse for sending people into spaces that machines can clean. The objective cannot be to make manual cleaning safer. It must be to make it unnecessary.

What India needs is a national deadline for eliminating hazardous human entry into sewers and septic tanks; mandate mechanised cleaning wherever feasible; make municipalities and contractors liable for violations; ensure that every worker and family receives compensation and rehabilitation where deaths occur; and publish transparent, state-wise data on every sewer-related fatality. There should be no ambiguity, no escape route and no distinction between the sanitation worker who entered a sewer and the official who authorised it.

The machine should go down. The human being should not. Because the real measure of a developed country is not how high it can fly. It is how low it is willing to look. And whether, when it looks down, it sees a machine doing a job that once demanded a human life. India has spent 80 years trying to become modern. It is time we finally modernised the drain.





# The Car That Gets Richer After You Sell It

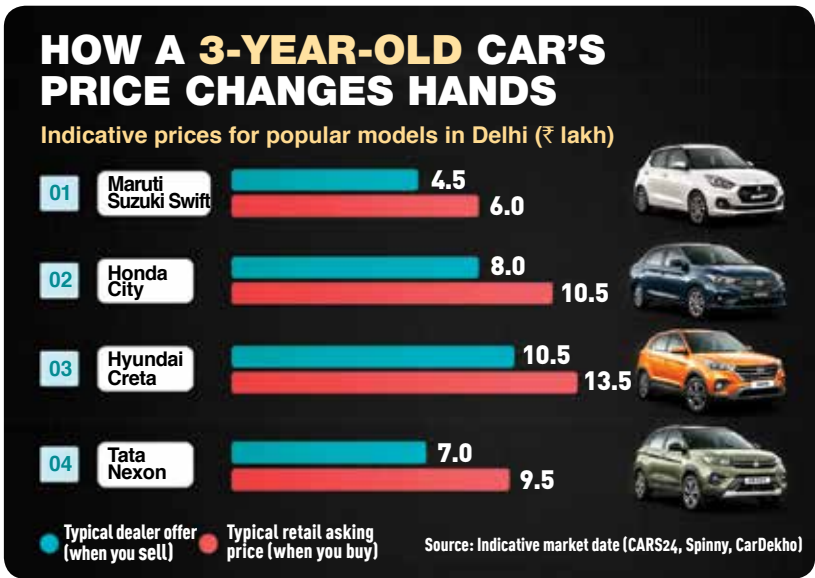
*In India’s used-car market, a vehicle can be declared worthless when you sell it. It can also suddenly become a premium deal when someone else sells it to you*

AUTHOR

RAJEEV NARAYAN

There is something wonderfully elastic about the value of a used car in India. It can shrink dramatically when you are selling it. And expand with supernatural enthusiasm when someone is selling it to you. Try selling a two-year-old car and you are told that the market is weak, the variant unpopular, colour difficult, mileage high, tyres need changing and, of course, nobody really wants that model anymore.

Try buying the same car a few days later and watch the transformation. It is now a ‘well-maintained, single-owner example’ equipped with premium



accessories, additional loadings and excellent city usability. The very features that dragged down its value when you owned it have somehow become reasons for the next buyer to pay more. Welcome to India’s wonderfully creative used-car market.

#### The Two Prices

The basic problem is simple. The person selling the car knows what he paid for it, how much he spent maintaining it

and how much emotional attachment he has developed to it. What he does not know is what the market is actually prepared to pay. The dealer knows far more. He knows what similar cars are going for. He knows what it will cost to refurbish the car, how much margin he wants, how quickly he needs to move it and even how urgently the seller needs to get rid of it.

That is hardly an even negotiation. The seller hears the litany: “This model has no resale; nobody wants it. The accessories don’t have value. We will have to spend on it.” Then the car disappears into the system. A little later, it reappears with a different biography and a mysteriously higher asking price. The car has not become younger. The engine hasn’t discovered extra horses. The tyres haven’t grown new tread. Yet, its value has undergone a spiritual transformation.

SELL YOUR VEHICLE AND ITS ACCESSORIES ARE ALL JUNK. BUY IT BACK IN JUST A WEEK AND THOSE SAME ADD-ONS HAVE ACQUIRED AN INCREDIBLE FINANCIAL PERSONALITY

#### What Accessories?

Accessories are a standout example. When you sell, the alloys you bought, the upgraded infotainment system, the reverse camera, the dashcam, the premium floor mats or the fancy lights are treated as though they were embarrassing personal indulgences. “They don’t have resale value,” you are told. Fair enough. Until you try buying a used car. Those same accessories are suddenly part of a great package worth tens of thousands of rupees. The previous owner spent heavily on them and you are, therefore, getting excellent value. There is a philosophical lesson here: accessories have no value when leaving your pocket, but considerable value when entering somebody else’s.

#### The Makeover

Variants provide another source of amusement. Take the IMT, for instance. When an owner wants to sell, the transmission acquires an unfortunate reputation. It is an awkward variant—not quite manual,

not quite automatic; a little niche and tough to sell. After the sale, the same car undergoes a miraculous makeover. It is now a practical city car. No clutch. Easy driving in traffic. Manual-like control without the fatigue of operating a clutch. The vehicle has not changed. The audience has.

This is not to say every dealer plays games. Used-car retail is a business, and any business is entitled to make money. The problem begins when the buyer or seller has no reliable way of knowing where the legitimate margin ends and the creative storytelling begins.

#### Buyers Beware

There is a serious side too. A used car can look magnificent and still conceal a history that only a trained eye or a diagnostic machine can uncover. A temporary fix may have been made to survive a sale, not last for a few years. Parts can be changed. Tyres can be swapped. Cosmetic work can make accident damage look less dramatic than it was.

Accessories? They have an extraordinary ability to migrate. The expensive alloy wheels that attracted you to one car may not necessarily remain there forever. Nor should a buyer assume that every shiny addition visible in the photographs is permanently married to the vehicle. This does not mean that every used car is a trap. There are superb used cars available, often at prices that make new-car buyers wonder why they are paying so much for the privilege of removing the polythene from a new seat.

But the buyer has to do the homework.

#### Dealer’s Margin

The used-car business has made buying and selling easier, cleaner and more convenient. Platforms have brought technology, financing, warranties, inspections and processes into a market that was once dominated by the neighbourhood dealer and a handwritten ‘For Sale’ sign. That’s progress.

But convenience comes at a price, and the customer should understand what that price is. A platform or dealer has to refurbish the car, pay staff, maintain facilities, handle paperwork, provide warranties, finance inventory and absorb the risk of a car sitting unsold. There is nothing wrong with making money from that business. The question is whether the seller understands the spread between the price at which his car is bought and what it is eventually sold for.

That is where the Indian used-car market needs something it has historically lacked: transparency. The seller should know why his car is being valued at a particular number. The buyer should know why another number is being demanded. The condition of the vehicle should be third-party verifiable. Accessories should have a rational value. Repairs should be disclosed. And the market value of a car should not depend on which side of the desk you are sitting on.

In India, a car has two lives: one before the dealer buys it and another after. In the first, it depreciates, is difficult to sell and comes burdened with worthless accessories. In the second, it is ‘well maintained’, feature-loaded and attractively priced. The miracle is not that used cars depreciate. It is that they seem to appreciate between owners. Perhaps it is time for the market to explain that trick.

## Wellness

# The Crisis Before Suicide



*Suicidal crises can be intense but temporary; timely conversation, human contact and professional intervention can create the crucial distance between an impulse and an irreversible act*

AUTHOR

ERA DUTTA

instead make it easier for someone to disclose what they are experiencing.

Then listen. You do not have to solve their marriage, examination, financial crisis, grief or depression at 2 a.m. You have to help them get through 2 a.m.

If the risk is immediate, do not leave the person alone. Reduce access to potentially lethal means. Involve someone they trust and seek urgent professional help. And stay connected afterwards.

Suicide prevention is not only about the crisis itself. The days and weeks afterwards matter too.

**Can medication stop the crisis?**

Ketamine and esketamine have attracted considerable attention because they can produce rapid antidepressant effects, sometimes within hours rather than the weeks associated with conventional antidepressants. But they should not be understood as magic emergency treatments. These medications require specialist assessment and supervision. In an acute crisis, safety, human contact and appropriate clinical care come first.

Suicide is often spoken about as though it is a decision. Clinically, it is more complicated. A person in a suicidal crisis may genuinely believe that death is the only way to end unbearable psychological pain. Yet that same person can feel very differently hours or days later.

That gap between the permanence of suicide and the temporary nature of many suicidal crises is one of the most important facts in suicide prevention.

September 10 is World Suicide Prevention Day. This year’s theme, the final year of a three-year campaign, is “Changing the Narrative on Suicide”, with a simple call to action: “Start the Conversation.”

Perhaps that is where prevention begins.

**When the mind becomes a tunnel**

During an acute suicidal crisis, thinking can become dramatically narrowed. Psychiatrists call this cognitive constriction. The person may stop seeing multiple possibilities and become fixated on one solution. The future feels inaccessible. Problems that might normally seem manageable can suddenly feel impossible, and the ability to see consequences can become impaired.

Which is why telling someone to “think positively”, reminding them how much they have to live for, or giving them a lecture about consequences may do little in the acute moment.

The immediate goal is simpler: Create time between the crisis and the action.

A crisis can change. The problem may not disappear, but the intensity of the urge can.

**What does prevention actually look like?**

It often begins with a question: “Are you thinking about suicide?”

There is a persistent myth that asking directly will put the idea into someone’s head. Evidence does not support this. A calm, direct question can

## SUICIDE PREVENTION BEGINS BY MAKING THE NEXT 10 MINUTES SAFER

### The numbers matter

India recorded 1,70,746 suicides in 2024. Student suicides reached 14,488, nearly 80 per cent higher than a decade earlier.

We cannot prevent every suicide by saying the right thing. But we can make the next ten minutes safer.

- Ask directly.
- Listen without judgement.
- Bring in help.
- Create time.

Sometimes suicide prevention is not about finding the perfect answer to someone’s life. It is about making sure they are still here when the answer becomes visible.

Every life matters. You matter.

If you or someone you know is in immediate danger, seek emergency medical help. In India, you can also contact iCALL at 9152987821 or the Vandrevalla Foundation at 1860 2662 345.



# Across an 'Unequal' Landscape

*In A Patch of Sun, a Patch of Shade, an unlikely friendship between two girls reveals the deep inequality embedded in the social world of plantation life*

AUTHOR



SANJEEV CHOPRA

That the title of the book *A Patch of Sun, a Patch of Shade* by Vidya Nesarikar immediately brought my mind to Mulk Raj Anand's *Two Leaves and a Bud*, published in 1937, is perhaps not surprising. Both stories are set on plantations – the first on a coffee plantation at Saklespur in the Coorg region of Karnataka, and the second on a tea plantation in Assam. Both involve children of migrant workers, and they draw their titles from the plucking metaphor. *Two leaves and a bud* represent the finest standard for fine tea, while a patch of sun and a patch of shade reflect the life cycle of coffee grown on the estate.

Many decades have passed between Mulk Raj Anand and Vidya Nesarikar. Some things have changed, but many have not. By the mid-1980s, the time period in which

Nesarikar's story is set, Europeans have sold their estates to prosperous Indians. The enactment – though indifferent implementation – of the Plantations Act of 1951 saw an improvement in the wages of workers. Unlike in colonial times, owners, managers and workers now spoke the same language, worshipped the same gods, ate the same delicacies, and their children played the same games.

But some things have not changed. The class divide is so stark and clear: the owner's family – Kantha Gowda, Nanjamma and Champa – live in the palatial Murari Champa, while the plantation workers are confined to the lines. At least socially, the twain shall never meet. One must add here that, post-liberalisation, the ubiquitous mobile phone and the right-to-work and right-to-food legislations have changed power equations in the workers' favour, but the possibilities of a fraternal friendship are still not typically within the realm of the real.

Ownership of a coffee estate – however large and profitable – does not confer immunity from death, disease and despair. If anything, the lives of both mother and daughter of the estate are distraught. The mother has not recovered from the loss of her first-born son and is embarrassed to have a daughter with vitiligo.



NESARIKAR LOOKS AT CHILDHOOD THROUGH TWO GIRLS SEPARATED BY PRIVILEGE BUT UNITED BY FRIENDSHIP

Her daughter, who is one of the two protagonists in this 160-page novella, is equally, if not more, upset with her skin condition of white patches. She hates being mocked and often pitied by family and friends, especially cousins of the same age. While she cannot understand her mother's grief, she craves her mother's affection and attention. She drops out of school, for she can't bear the taunts, and

her playmates – especially the boys – often refuse to let her join the games.

Into her lonely world comes Lalli, the eleven-year-old daughter of migrant workers Dhanappa and Shivamma from the other end of Karnataka. Lalli, too, is homesick and forlorn, for there are no children in the labour lines – and both parents work from morn to night to pluck as much coffee as they can, for their earnings are linked to the pluckings. Lalli is left to fend for herself, but she learns about the gardens around her by climbing trees, eating fruit and chatting with the other women who gather around the hand pump to draw water. When she finds Champa, she knows she has found a friend. Lalli teaches Champa new games, and Champa finds a companion in Lalli who doesn't make fun of her skin condition. The girls come from vastly different worlds, but the estate provides them with a setting in which they become very close. Lalli is admitted to the same school, St Thomas Convent in Saklespur. On the very first day, Lalli throws a shoe at a boy who was bullying Champa, after which the two friends remain registered for the exams but are asked to study at home. Champa enjoys her reading and is proficient in languages and maths. Lalli resents books but knows many things through observation – her understanding of soils and her knowledge of trees, fruits,

animals and culture show how invested she is in her immediate environment.

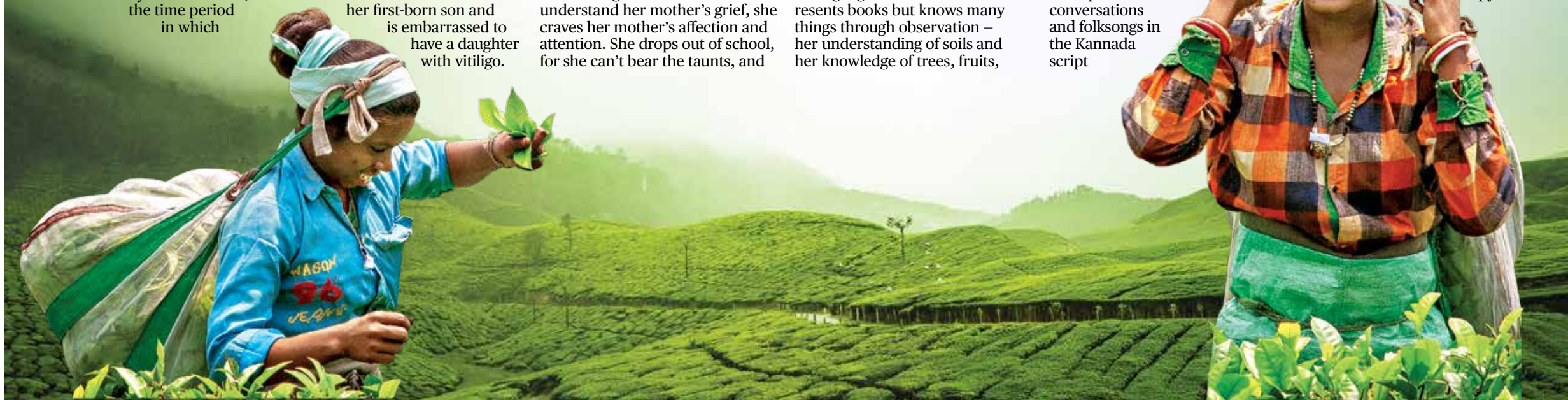
The class asymmetry between the two friends is implicit. But Vidya leaves it for her readers to uncover this deep divide. She talks about the places they live in and their individual families, but she focuses more on their friendship. Both girls discuss the difficulties and challenges associated with the onset of the menstrual cycle and wish this would afflict the boys as well. As the coffee season runs its course, they learn things about themselves and about the world they are growing into. Their unlikely bond is tested as Champa's skin condition begins improving, and it becomes unclear whether her impossible friendship with Lalli will survive the coffee season. Although Dhanappa and Shivamma believe that the girls' friendship is akin to that of the legendary Krishna and Sudama – the king who relishes the grain brought by his poor friend – the realm of the real in these times has different moralities in hesitating to confront the privilege of their birth.

What is best about this book is its setting in interior Karnataka, and the narrative is interspersed with conversations and folksongs in the Kannada script

(with translations) in the book. The games the girls play and the food they eat are all in Kannada, and it is rare to have a plantation story with teenage Indian girls as protagonists.

What are the takeaways? Young Adult (YA) books will have many a happy moment, but not necessarily a happy ending. The *desh-kaal* settings of space and time in Coorg can teach the English-Medium-Types many a thing about what hinterland Karnataka was like a few decades ago: when the power supply was erratic and landlines worked sparingly. The stories from India's ancient traditions continue to find resonance in the lives of people across classes and communities in the country. And last, but not least, while this may be classified as a YA book, it is equally meaningful and pleasurable for adults. Congratulations to Vidya for sharing the world of Murari Champa and the labour lines with

us, and letting us know that we still have a long way to go as a nation to usher in equity for those who are at the bottom of the pyramid.



# The Economics of Hunger

*Veena S Rao's India's Undernutrition and Human Capital argues that India cannot build strong human capital without first confronting chronic undernutrition*

AUTHOR

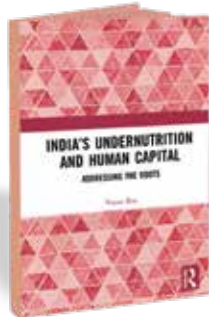


RINA RAY

That India has perhaps the world's largest school meal programme is well known. Equally well known is that Tamil Nadu was the first state in both pre- and post-Independence India to start such an initiative. However, how many people know that, in 1946, the USA passed legislation to provide school lunches, explicitly framing feeding children as a measure of national security? In her book, Veena S Rao shares the fascinating insight that a large number of American men were found unfit for military service during World War II on account of physical deficiencies resulting from childhood malnutrition, and that this so alarmed Congress that it enacted the National School Lunch Act in 1946 as a measure of national security and to protect the future of the country and its people. This book contains many

such invaluable nuggets of information, and it is a must-read for everyone interested in the fields of human development, public health and nutrition, and public policy. It very clearly and categorically defines the intersectoral factors that determine strong human capital, placing nutrition in its rightful place as the foundation for all future development in health, education, skills, income and economic progress. She has also delved into the vast body of written works on the subject of public nutrition and has shared insightful details on the highly detrimental and long-term impact of colonial policies on India's human capital and the policy responses from Independence to the present day, highlighting what worked and what did not.

One of the most compelling parts of the book details the intersectoral, intergenerational strategy architected by the author that was implemented under the World Bank-funded Karnataka Multisectoral Nutrition Pilot Projects (KMNPP) in the two most backward blocks of the state, namely Chincholi in Gulbarga district and Devadurga in Raichur district. These pilots were led by the author, and readers will indeed be interested



“A GLOBAL POWER WITH DEVELOPED INFRASTRUCTURE AND UNDERDEVELOPED HUMAN CAPITAL WOULD SUFFER FROM ACUTE CONTRADICTIONS AND BIPOLARITY...”

– Veena S Rao

to learn that both the real-time data analysis within the projects, as well as the third-party Impact Assessment conducted by the National Institute of Nutrition in 2019, provide evidence of a significant improvement in the nutritional and health status of the target groups, as well as in behavioural change among and within families. These included a significant

reduction in the incidence of wasting and underweight among 6-35-month-old children, an increase in the proportion of adolescent girls aged 11-18 years with "normal" weight, and an increase in mean pregnancy weight gain and mean birth weight of newborns.

These results are indeed commendable, and it is well worth studying



the interventions and methodology and their actual implementation on the ground. The author explains that she implemented a mix of interventions that were essentially comprehensive, intergenerational and intersectoral in nature. These broadly followed the recommendations of the Coalition for Sustainable Nutrition Security in India, chaired by the late Professor M S Swaminathan in May 2010, with additional initiatives introduced by the author based on her long-term experience in this sector. Recognising that the projects were covering the most backward areas of the state, the KMNPP created IEC material that specifically targeted the challenges and concerns of the community there, rather than sharing general information that

may have been prepared for the entire district or state. The provision of nutritious food under the projects to children, adolescent girls and pregnant mothers played a major role in breaking the intergenerational cycle of undernutrition and micronutrient deficiency, while the emphasis on involving the family, community, local bodies and governmental agencies successfully created a block-level homogeneous team that worked together to achieve the goals.

The author's assertion on the huge role that nutrition plays in the development of human capital and, consequently, in the nation's GDP needs to be taken very seriously. She has cogently presented how chronic intergenerational protein-calorie-

micronutrient deficiency prevents children from achieving their complete cognitive and physical development, denying them the opportunity to reach their fullest learning potential. This translates into adolescents with low skills and earning capacity, and as adults, they remain trapped within the intergenerational cycle of poverty, malnutrition and poor health. Her firm insistence that the fundamental correlation between nutritional status and economic productivity must be taken into consideration by mainstream economists, and that public nutrition must enter the GDP debate, is a clarion call to everyone searching for answers on the way ahead for our human capital and demographic dividend. Readers are also provided with first-time information regarding the origin of the Poshan Abhiyaan led by Hon'ble Justice M N Venkatachaliah, details of stakeholder consultations, its announcement in the Budget on July 10, 2014, and its progression thereafter.

The book identifies the major root causes of India's chronic undernutrition and micronutrient deficiency and also recommends several practical actions to bridge the causal deficits.

Planetary Balance

PART III

Oceans at the Brink

AUTHOR



KRISHNA GUPTA

Oceans have absorbed much of the planet's excess heat, but warming waters are now accelerating ice loss and locking in dangerous sea-level rise

In the last two articles, we discussed the various types of ocean currents and their role in regulating heat and salinity across and within the oceans. In the third part, we will discuss the importance of the oceans as giant heat sinks and how they will play an important role in the long term, till the end of this century and beyond.

The Rising Emissions, Heating and the Oceans

We have seen in this series that carbon emissions continue unabated, and with the ongoing Iran war, it is likely that fossil fuel mining and burning by countries like India, China, Australia and Indonesia will only increase. The link between rising emissions and increasing temperatures across the Earth has been scientifically established. Climate models suggest that if countries continue with their current policies, temperatures are likely to rise by 2.8-3.2°C, while even if carbon dioxide reduction pledges are met, they could rise by 2.5-2.8°C.

Further, carbon

dioxide in the atmosphere is already at 430 ppm, and any further rise will have direct implications for ocean warming and its ability to absorb future heat.

Oceans as Giant Sinks  
Rising emissions and global temperatures have contributed to the shrinking of Arctic and Antarctic ice sheets and glaciers. More specifically, the Greenland ice sheet has been melting at an accelerating rate of about 260-270 gigatons (Gt) per year on average since 2002, going up to 600 Gt in the warm years of 2012-19. This translates to about a 0.7 mm annual rise in sea levels. It is estimated that the current carbon dioxide concentration in the atmosphere has already locked in a future sea-level rise of 27 cm. Other estimates suggest that melting of the Greenland ice sheet will raise sea levels by 10-16 cm by the end of the century. The locked-in 27 cm rise will cause serious inundation and infrastructure damage in the Indian and Pacific Oceans. In the Indian Ocean, India and its coastal cities will be badly hit,



THE OCEANS ARE STORING THE CONSEQUENCES OF DECADES OF RISING EMISSIONS

including Mumbai, Chennai and Visakhapatnam, as well as West Bengal and the Sundarbans. Bangladesh, Vietnam and Indonesia will also be impacted. In the Pacific, the East Coast of the USA, including New York and Miami, as well as New Orleans and the Mississippi Delta, will be impacted. Small Pacific islands such as Tuvalu, Vanuatu, Kiribati, Fiji and the Solomon Islands

face severe threats. European cities such as Venice, London and Rotterdam will need stronger sea defences. Sea-level rise will be compounded by storm surges, saltwater intrusion and infrastructure damage. Let us look at Antarctica now. Incidents of calving from large glaciers have increased since 2015 because of warmer ocean waters. In particular, the breaking

away of a 225-square-mile chunk of the Pine Island Glacier in 2015 indicated that warmer ocean water was seeping beneath the glacier and creating rifts, leading to more frequent calving. Similarly, the neighbouring Thwaites Glacier is losing ice at 50 Gt per year, accounting for 4% of global sea-level rise. Thwaites is even more critical, not only because of its size—it is roughly the size of Great Britain—but also because of its 'cork' effect. The glacier acts as a massive dam, holding back large ice masses of West Antarctica. Thwaites alone has the potential to raise sea levels by 65 cm, or about two feet. If the Thwaites Glacier collapses, it could also destabilise neighbouring glaciers, potentially contributing to a massive sea-level rise of 3 metres. This criticality gives Thwaites the name 'Doomsday Glacier'.

Then there is the Larsen Ice Shelf in Antarctica, which has been shedding large chunks of ice, with the massive A-68 iceberg breaking off from Larsen C in 2017. Larsen A and Larsen

B had earlier collapsed in 1995 and 2002. A-68 weighed around one trillion tons and its separation reduced the area of Larsen C by 12%. Particularly worrying is the role of warmer ocean currents and 'atmospheric rivers'—streams of warm, moist air that contribute to surface melting, ultimately allowing glaciers to flow faster into the oceans and raise sea levels.

Conclusion

Oceans and ocean currents are critical to the way climate change will impact us. With warmer ocean waters chipping away at ice shelves and glaciers, sea-level rise is inevitable. The melting of the Greenland ice sheet alone has locked in a substantial future sea-level rise. In the longer term, the melting of Antarctic glaciers is an even greater cause for concern. It seems that shutting down fossil fuels immediately may not be enough: other mitigation and adaptation measures, along with ramped-up R&D, which we have discussed in this series, are a must.



GAME ON



AUTHOR



S KANNAN

India's Asian Games RECKONING

From shooting and athletics to hockey and badminton, Aichi-Nagoya will test India's medal ambitions, sporting depth and readiness for the road to Los Angeles 2028

Asian Games campaign from September 19 to October 3. Standards in the Asian Games have increased manifold. It is for this reason that the Ministry of Youth Affairs and Sports does not clear all and sundry to travel for the Asian Games as if it is an exposure tour. The amount of foreign travel Indian athletes enjoy today is massive, all at the taxpayers' expense. To support athletes who have not made it big is one thing. Certainly, a PV Sindhu, Manu Bhaker or Mirabai Chanu does not need funds from the Central Pool.

How these celebrated athletes fare will be watched with interest. Indian sport is poised dangerously if you look at it through the prism of doping and governance. Day in and day out, there are cases of dope cheats hitting the headlines. Athletics, weightlifting, wrestling, swimming, wushu and judo have all caused embarrassment.

Doping in Indian sports is a shame. Global media highlights Indians flunking dope tests and being placed under suspension. The testing protocols within India and scrutiny by WADA – the World Anti-Doping Agency – and other agencies are justified. At the National Dope Testing Laboratory in New Delhi, scientists are doing a good job. Here is hoping each Indian athlete in Aichi-Nagoya is clean and competes fair and square.

India wishes to host global sporting events. The 2030 Commonwealth Games in Ahmedabad is confirmed; next on the mission list is the 2036 Olympics. If India wishes to host the Olympics, the medal haul and performances have to go up. How India fares in the Asian

THE PERFORMANCE IN NAGOYA COULD REVEAL HOW FAR INDIA REALLY IS FROM OLYMPIC AMBITION

Games and LA 2028 Olympics will therefore be important. Each doping case is also being noticed by the International Olympic Committee (IOC). An impression has already been created that Indian sport is not clean. Harsh punishment has to be meted out to dope cheats; mere suspension does not work.

In Nagoya, no medal is going to come easy. In shooting, India are expected to do well, with fresh faces and seasoned stars appearing in good form. The pressure of expectation is high for Manu Bhaker after she won two bronze medals at the Paris 2024 Olympics. Esha Singh did well at the last Asian Games in Hangzhou. Now, Suruchi Phogat in pistol and the hungry rifle shooters need to come good in Nagoya.

Expectations from track and field are high. One has lost count of how many national records have been broken in recent months at home. In the absence of Neeraj Chopra, out with an ankle injury, the focus will be on Ancy Sojan and Shaili Singh in the long jump. Ancy has been in sublime form, so how the two girls push each other will be good to see. The

return of Avinash Sable, the sturdy steeplechaser, is also awaited. He did well on Thursday in New Delhi at the final domestic meet in the 3,000m steeplechase. The last year has been dark and dank for Sable after he sustained an ACL tear. He looks good now.

Some performances at the CWG in Glasgow in July were also heartening. Can Tejaswin Shankar again do well in the gruelling decathlon? The sturdy star did well to cross 8,000 points at home. In Glasgow, he overcame the pain barrier to win a bronze medal.

Shooting and athletics will be India's main hopes, though Indian boxers, notably the girls, will be seen as medal prospects. Indian wrestling, too, is expected to deliver medals. This sport has moved beyond the drama enacted by Vinesh Phogat. There are fresher faces who can do well and win medals, though doping incidents at home in wrestling are worrying.

For emotional reasons, Indian hockey is always a favourite. The men's and women's teams have their task cut out. At the FIH World Cup in Amstelveen, India did not do well, and coach Craig Fulton is now under attack. Fulton did guide India to gold at the Hangzhou Asia and bronze at the Paris Olympics. A gold medal is a must, as it will ensure direct qualification for the LA Olympics.

This time, the hype over the women's team is good. To finish fifth in the FIH World Cup recently is great. Like it or lump it, coach Sjoerd Marijne has done well to bring the best out of the girls. In terms of fitness and speed, the girls are fearless. Hockey India needs a reset too. Bad governance and

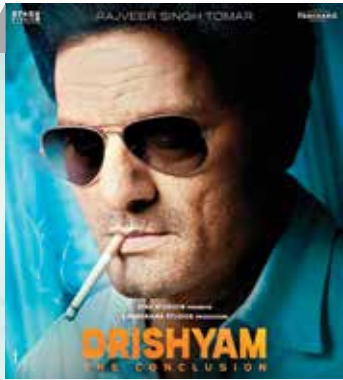
allegations of harassment against Secretary General Bholanath Singh are serious. A probe committee is in place, and Bholanath will be under scrutiny. President Dilip Tirkey, known for his skills as a player and former India captain, has been overshadowed. Tirkey spoke of how the blue dress code will be back for the Indian hockey teams. The colour change is not too significant; what is needed is a change in performance standards from the men.

Winning gold is not a demand; it is a justified desire. Crores of rupees are spent on Indian hockey, the coaches, support staff and scientific advisers. Hockey has an emotional connect at home, so India expects two gold medals from Aichi-Nagoya.

Lastly, for Sat-Chi, the famous badminton doubles pair, competing in Aichi-Nagoya should be enjoyable. Satwiksairaj Rankireddy and Chirag Shetty are the China Masters champions, so they have tuned in well. India will also wish Treasa Jolly and Gayatri Gopichand good luck. Their bronze medal at the BWF World Championships in New Delhi three weeks back was awesome.



# 'NEVER FELT THAT I WASN'T A PART OF THIS WORLD'



## Jaideep Ahlawat opened up about joining 'Drishyam 3' after Akshaye Khanna's exit

Jaideep Ahlawat said he didn't worry that his character in 'Drishyam 3' will be compared to the one played by Akshaye Khanna in the first two movies of the thriller franchise. The 'Paatal Lok' star joined the franchise after Khanna's abrupt exit earlier this year. Khanna played IPS Tarun Ahlawat in the first two films.

In the third and final chapter of the Ajay Devgn-led thriller franchise, Ahlawat stars as SP Crime Branch Rajveer Singh Tomar, who goes after Vijay Salgaonkar (Ajay Devgn) and his family.

Asked if replacing Khanna in the franchise came with the pressure of comparisons, Ahlawat said the way director Abhishek Pathak made the transition easy for him.

"No, not at all. The way Abhishek had written the script and the dialogues, I never felt that I wasn't a part of this world. When I heard the script, it didn't feel like this character was coming in place of Akshaye sir's character. One character's journey has ended and another character has been introduced. So, I felt there was no point in feeling pressured by his character. It's going to be a completely different journey. The introduction will be new. There will be new relationships with Meera and the Deshmukhs or the Salgaonkars," Ahlawat told reporters at the trailer launch of the film in Panaji.

He said Pathak worked extensively on building Rajveer Singh Tomar's arc. "When Abhishek narrated the script to me, I didn't feel that this character was there because of any other character. It will take a bit of time to understand who Tomar is, but they have done a thorough job

with the character - from his hairstyle and costume to his sunglasses. Abhishek explained everything to me and that's why the job became a bit easier. And then you have such an amazing cast that you feel relaxed," he added.

The actor recalled his long association with the franchise's leading man Devgn, saying his first film, 'Aakrosh', starred Devgn and was produced by Kumar Mangat Pathak. Ahlawat also said he has long been an admirer of Tabu, who has been an integral part of the Hindi 'Drishyam'.

Tabu said, "Everybody knows how brilliant he is. I called him after watching 'Paatal Lok'. Didn't I, Jaideep sir? And I had looked for his number. It came during the pandemic and that was one of the very few shows I've watched in my life and he's just brilliant."

In 'Drishyam', Devgn played the role of Vijay Salgaonkar, a cable operator in Goa, who lives a peaceful life with his wife Nandini and their two daughters. His world turns upside down when a teenage boy goes missing and his family becomes the prime suspect in the case.

'Drishyam: The Conclusion' picks up from where the second film ended, with Vijay and his family facing renewed pressure as old secrets and unanswered questions threaten to resurface. Vijay also encounters a formidable new adversary in Rajveer Singh Tomar, who takes charge of the seemingly impossible case and is determined to uncover the truth behind the boy's disappearance. The film brings back Devgn as Vijay Salgaonkar alongside Tabu as Meera Deshmukh, Shriya Saran as Nandini Salgaonkar and Rajat Kapoor as Mahesh Deshmukh. Prakash Raj also joins the cast in a pivotal role. PTI

## 'HEARTBEATS' SEASON 2

# Old equations, new dynamics!

The white coats are back & so are the complicated feelings, messy equations and unresolved questions

**OUR CORRESPONDENT**

The white coats are back and so are the complicated feelings, messy equations and unresolved questions that made 'Heartbeats' a binge-worthy watch on 'Prime Video'. Season 2 of this much-loved 'MX Original' brings audiences back into the world of Veridian Hospital, but this time, the emotional stakes feel higher and the lines between personal and professional are blurrier than ever.

With old equations evolving, new dynamics taking shape and a few secrets waiting to surface, the 20-episode medical dramedy, directed by Tanmai Rastogi, has plenty to keep audiences guessing.

Here are four reasons why 'Heartbeats' S2 deserves a spot on your watchlist:

**Veridian Hospital... back like never before:** There is something instantly addictive about stepping back into a world you already know, especially when it comes with a whole new set of complications. 'Heartbeats' S2 brings back the doctors & corridors of Veridian Hospital



while opening the door to fresh conflicts, changing equations and unexpected turns. With familiar faces returning and new equations taking shape, Season 2 takes audiences deeper into the lives of the young doctors they have come to know and root for.

**Complicated matters of the heart:** The core of 'Heartbeats' has always been its relationships and Season 2 doubles down on what makes them so watchable. Akshat and Saanjh return with plenty of unfinished business, but this time there is another force complicating their equation. With Rohan Gurbaxani joining the mix as Aditya, the dynamics become even more intriguing. Add different ambitions,

personalities and ideas of what the future should look like and suddenly the question is not simply about who ends up with whom. It's about what people are willing to choose when the heart and everything else pull them in different directions.

**More than one story:** Season 2 is brought to life by an incredible cast and one of its pleasures is that there is no single relationship carrying the entire season. Harsh Beniwal and Shivangi Joshi return as Akshat and Saanjh, while Rohan Gurbaxani's Aditya brings a new dynamic into their story. Yuvraj Dua, Naqiah Hazi, Ankit Siwach and Aditi Sharma further expand the world as Rishi, Nayantara, Samar and Pooja.

That gives the series room to move between romance, friendship, ambition and the pressures of hospital life without staying locked into one equation. The result is an ensemble where a shift in one relationship can have consequences for another, especially as the professional tensions at Veridian begin spilling into personal lives.

**The medical world gets a mystery of its own:** There is more happening at Veridian than what meets the eye. Apart from the everyday pressure of medicine and the race for professional recognition, Season 2 raises the stakes considerably as the young doctors begin getting caught up in something much darker inside the hospital: a medical scam. As they get closer to the truth, the series moves beyond the familiar themes of hospital life and into questions of ethics, money and how far people are willing to go to protect their interests.

Whether you are here for complicated relationships, friendships, hospital drama or simply to see what is next for Akshat, Saanjh and the gang, 'Heartbeats' S2 brings it all together in one entertaining new chapter!

## 'Vibe not a spoof of Pathaan & Tiger'



Kunal Kemmu talked about his new spy-comedy film, in which he stars alongside Sparsh Shrivastava of 'Lapaataa Ladies' fame

Actor-filmmaker Kunal Kemmu said his upcoming directorial 'Vibe' is not a spoof or parody of any Bollywood film and features dialogues around 'Pathaan' and 'Tiger' as they are the most popular pop culture references in the spy genre.

Written and directed by Kemmu, the film follows two friends, played by Kemmu and Sparsh Shrivastava of 'Lapaataa Ladies' fame, who find themselves caught up in a high-stakes mission despite having no training or experience as spies.

In one of the dialogues that features in the film's trailer, Kemmu's character questions why he must be sent for a dangerous mission when there are capable spies like Pathaan and Tiger, characters played by Shah Rukh Khan and Salman Khan in YRF's hit franchise.

In an interview with PTI, Kemmu said the story has been with him since 2015, but the idea to reference these two characters came later.

"I've had this story with me even before I became a director. I've narrated this to friends. I didn't write it then because I didn't know whether it would be made or not," Kemmu, who made his directorial debut with the 2024 crime comedy, 'Madgaon Express', said.

The references to popular spies, like Pathaan and Tiger, the actor-director said, come from the fact that an ordinary person caught in an extraordinary situation would naturally turn to the characters he knows from pop culture.

"At that point in time, 'Pathaan' had definitely not come out. But it was just about what this character would feel. It was not taking a swing at anybody. Like, it was genuinely saying that for this normal man, like if I get picked up, I will say, 'You pick up somebody who's good at this'," he said.

He added, "The idea of getting into the spy world, when you actually see the film, you'll understand why what is happening - it's all logical; it's not farcical. It is kind of over-the-top in the way that is happening with them. But it's not a spoof; it's not a parody of any film."

Comedy has defined much of Kemmu's career, both as an actor and now as a director and while it remains one of his favourite genres, he doesn't want to be defined

solely by it.

"I didn't think that I would land in a category. I'm very honoured. But I've never taken that pressure or tried to say that this is what I want to be known for. I've let my instinct and voice just go with the flow," he said.

"I consume a lot of comedies. But then again, when it comes to my own writing, subconsciously maybe, yes, I am inspired by them," the actor-director said, adding that he admires the way American filmmaker Wes Anderson makes his movies.



COMEDY HAS DEFINED MUCH OF KEMMU'S CAREER, BOTH AS AN ACTOR AND NOW AS A DIRECTOR

The actor-director recalled, "He's a wonderful filmmaker who has humour in his storytelling. He's not necessarily a comic filmmaker, but he does humour in a very interesting way."

Kemmu said he is eager to branch into other genres and has scripts ready for horror, action and a dark film.

"But as of now, people feel more comfortable investing in me in this humour zone. But I do want to tell other stories; I'll do one or two comedies now and then I will want to make one in a different genre."

The cast of 'Vibe' also includes Preity G Zinta, Vanishika Dhir, Dinesh Lal Yadav, Yashpal Sharma and others.

Produced by Kemmu and Chirag Nihalani under their production banner 'Drongo Films', in association with 'Amazon MGM Studios', 'Vibe' will be out in cinemas on September 18. PTI